🎯 2026 PRELIMS & RO/ARO SPECIAL · COMPLETE CHAPTER-WISE PYQS

ANCIENT INDIA PYQ MASTER

प्राचीन भारत का इतिहास — अध्यायवार पूर्व परीक्षा प्रश्नोत्तरी

Consolidated Chapter-wise Practice Bank covering all 14 topics.

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Ancient India — PYQ Master Index

Chapter-by-Chapter Authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Questions • All 14 Chapters

Ch 01. 01_Stone_Age.md
Stone Age (Prehistoric India)

Ch 02. 02_Indus_Valley
Indus Valley Civilization (Harappan Civilization)

Ch 03. 03_Vedic_Civili
Vedic Civilization

Ch 04. 04_Religious_Mo
Religious Movements

Ch 05. 05_Sixth_Centur
Sixth Century BCE

Ch 06. 06_Foreign_Inva
Foreign Invasions

Ch 07. 07_Mauryan_Empi
Mauryan Empire

Ch 08. 08_Post_Mauryan
Post-Mauryan India

Ch 09. 09_Gupta_Age.md
Gupta Age

Ch 10. 10_Post_Gupta_P
Post-Gupta Period

Ch 11. 11_Ancient_Indi
Ancient Indian Administration

Ch 12. 12_Ancient_Indi
Ancient Indian Economy

Ch 13. 13_Archaeology.
Archaeology

Ch 14. 14_Ancient_Indi
Ancient India Miscellaneous

Chapter 01: Stone Age (Prehistoric India) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which of the following Indian Archaeologists first visited 'Bhimbetka Caves' and discovered prehistoric significance of its rock paintings?

A Madho Swaroop Vatsa

B H.D. Sankalia

C V.S. Wakankar

D V.N. Mishra

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (V.S. Wakankar) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Archaeologist Profile:** Dr. **Vishnu Shridhar Wakankar** (1919–1988), an eminent Indian archaeologist and art historian from Vikram University, discovered the Bhimbetka rock shelters in **1957–1958**. He was honored with the Padma Shri in 1975 for his groundbreaking prehistoric discoveries. - **Site Geography:** Bhimbetka is located in the Vindhyan sandstone ranges of Raisen district, Madhya Pradesh (specifically near Abdullahganj, ~45 km south of Bhopal). It exhibits unbroken cultural stratigraphy from the Lower Paleolithic Acheulian horizon to the medieval period. - **Distractor Analysis:** - **Madho Swaroop Vatsa:** Associated with Harappan archaeology (excavated Harappa 1926–1934; author of *Excavations at Harappa*). - **H.D. Sankalia:** Led Deccan College excavations across Gujarat, Maharashtra, and Madhya Pradesh (Navdatoli, Nevasa, Langhnaj). - **V.N. Mishra:** Collaborated in later comprehensive surveys and excavations of Bhimbetka's rock-shelter III F-23 in the 1970s. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Remember the exact discovery anchor: **Dr. V.S. Wakankar, 1957–58, Raisen district, MP**. UNESCO inscribed Bhimbetka on the World Heritage List in **2003**.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Which among the following sites provides evidence of domestication of animals in the Mesolithic period?

A Odai

B Bori

C Bagor

D Lakhnia

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Bagor) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Evidence of Pastoralism:** In the Indian subcontinent, unequivocal excavated evidence of animal domestication begins in the **Mesolithic period** (Late Stone Age). - **Site Specifics:** **Bagor**, located on the Kothari river in Bhilwara district (Rajasthan), was excavated by **V.N. Misra**. Phase I yielded geometric microliths alongside faunal remains showing sheep, goat, and cattle domestication dated to c. 5000–4500 BCE. - **Central Indian Counterpart:** **Adamgarh** near Hoshangabad (Narmadapuram, MP), excavated by **R.V. Joshi**, yielded a parallel Mesolithic assemblage containing domestic dog, cattle, buffalo, sheep, and goat remains. - **Distractor Analysis:** - **Odai:** Minor lithic scatter in Tamil Nadu. - **Bori:** Lower Paleolithic Acheulian handaxe site in Maharashtra (~1.4 Ma). - **Lakhnia:** Vindhyan rock shelter in Mirzapur, UP (famed for rock paintings and burials). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - UPPCS pairing formula: Mesolithic animal domestication = **Bagor (Rajasthan) + Adamgarh (MP)**. Always eliminate Paleolithic (Bori, Attirampakkam) and pure burial sites (Sarai Nahar Rai, Damdama).

Q3 **UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023**

With reference to early humans in India, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Hathnora on the Narmada yielded a Homo sapiens cranium found by Robert Bruce Foote in 1863.
2. Attirampakkam in Tamil Nadu is famous as a Homo sapiens fossil site of the same horizon.
3. Robert Bruce Foote identified Paleolithic tools at Pallavaram in 1863.

A 1 and 2	**B** Only 3
C 2 and 3	**D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Only 3) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is INCORRECT:** While the fossil cranium at **Hathnora** on the Narmada River was indeed discovered in India, it was discovered by **Dr. Arun Sonakia of the Geological Survey of India on December 5, 1982**, NOT by Robert Bruce Foote in 1863. Furthermore, physical anthropologists classify the fossil cranium as an archaic hominin (**Homo erectus narmadensis** / archaic *Homo sapiens*), not anatomically modern *Homo sapiens*. - **Statement 2 is INCORRECT:** **Attirampakkam** in the Kortallayar basin (Tamil Nadu) is an internationally celebrated Lower Paleolithic **Acheulian stone tool site** (excavated by Robert Bruce Foote in 1863, and recently by Shanti Pappu revealing Acheulian tools dating to ~1.5 million years ago). It has yielded rich stone tools, animal footprints, and faunal fossils, but **no Homo sapiens fossil cranium**. - **Statement 3 is CORRECT:** **Robert Bruce Foote** discovered India's first recognized Paleolithic stone implement—an Acheulian quartzite bifacial handaxe—at **Pallavaram** near Chennai (Madras) on **May 30, 1863**. This historic discovery laid the foundation of prehistoric studies in India, earning Foote the title of "Father of Indian Prehistory." **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Disentangle the discoverers: - **Hathnora Hominin Fossil (1982)** = **Arun Sonakia** (Homo erectus, Narmada valley). - **Pallavaram Handaxe (1863)** = **Robert Bruce Foote** (First Paleolithic tool in India). - **Attirampakkam** = Acheulian tool site (NOT a Homo sapiens fossil site).

Q4 **UPPCS PRELIMS 2023**

Consider the following statements about Paleolithic tool traditions:

1. Lower Paleolithic tools are typically handaxes and cleavers of the Acheulian tradition.
2. Middle Paleolithic tools are mainly handaxes and cleavers of the Acheulian tradition.
3. The Soanian industry of the Soan–Siwalik belt is mainly handaxe-cleaver based.

A 1 and 2	**B** 2 and 3
C 1 and 3	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Only 1) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is CORRECT:** The **Lower Paleolithic** period in peninsular and central India is predominantly characterized by the **Acheulian tool tradition**, named after Saint-Acheul in France. Diagnostic tools are bifacial **handaxes** (pear-shaped or oval core tools flaked on both sides) and **cleavers** (tools with a wide, transverse cutting edge), accompanied by choppers and polyhedrons. - **Statement 2 is INCORRECT:** The **Middle Paleolithic** witnessed a major technological shift from core tools to **flake tools** (known in India as the **Nevasan tradition**, after Nevasa in Maharashtra). The characteristic tool types were **scrapers (side, convex, round, end), points, borers, and awls** made on flakes struck from prepared cores of fine-grained chert, jasper, and agate—NOT handaxes and cleavers. - **Statement 3 is INCORRECT:** The **Soanian industry** (discovered in the Soan/Sohan river valley of the Potwar plateau, Pakistan, by De Terra and Paterson) is celebrated for its **pebble chopper and chopping tools**, NOT microliths! Microliths are minute composite blades characteristic of the much later **Mesolithic Age**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Tool traditions by phase: - **Lower Paleolithic:** Acheulian handaxes, cleavers & Soanian pebble choppers. - **Middle Paleolithic:** Nevasan flake tools (scrapers, points, borers). - **Upper Paleolithic:** Blades and burins. - **Mesolithic:** Microliths (1–8 cm composite tools).

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Arrange the following cultural stages in chronological order (earliest first):

1. Neolithic
2. Paleolithic
3. Mesolithic
4. Chalcolithic

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 2, 1, 3, 4

B 3, 2, 1, 4

C 2, 3, 1, 4

D 2, 3, 4, 1

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (2, 3, 1, 4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Standard Prehistoric Chronological Progression:** - **2. Paleolithic Age (Old Stone Age, ~2.5 Million BCE to c. 10,000 BCE):** Longest phase of human history, marked by hunting, food gathering, and chipped core/flake stone tools. Subdivided into Lower, Middle, and Upper Paleolithic. - **3. Mesolithic Age (Middle Stone Age, c. 10,000 BCE to c. 7000/6000 BCE):** Transitional Holocene phase characterized by hunting-foraging, beginnings of animal domestication (Bagor, Adamgarh), and microlithic composite tools. - **1. Neolithic Age (New Stone Age, c. 7000 BCE to c. 2500 BCE in NW / later elsewhere):** Marked by the "Neolithic Revolution"—food production, agriculture (wheat, barley, rice), animal husbandry, polished stone celts, pottery, and permanent villages. - **4. Chalcolithic Age (Stone-Copper Age, c. 2500/2100 BCE to c. 700 BCE):** Metal-using non-urban village cultures utilizing copper tools alongside stone tools (e.g., Ahar, Malwa, Jorwe cultures). - **Correct Sequence:** 2 (Paleolithic) → 3 (Mesolithic) → 1 (Neolithic) → 4 (Chalcolithic). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Universal prehistoric ladder: **Paleolithic → Mesolithic → Neolithic → Chalcolithic → Bronze Age (Harappan) → Iron Age**.

Q6 **UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021**

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Site)	List-II (Specialty)
1 Bagor	A Upper Paleolithic shrine
2 Baghor	B Mesolithic domestication
3 Burzahom	C Bone and antler tools
4 Chirand	D Pit dwellings and dog burial

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

B 1-A, 2-B, 3-D, 4-C

C 1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-C

D 1-D, 2-A, 3-B, 4-C

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-C) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Detailed Matching Analysis:** - **1. Bagor → B. Mesolithic domestication:** Located on the Kothari River in Bhilwara, Rajasthan (excavated by V.N. Misra); provided the earliest benchmark evidence of domesticated sheep, goat, and cattle along with geometric microliths. - **2. Baghor → A. Upper Paleolithic shrine:** Located in the Son River Valley, Sidhi district, Madhya Pradesh (excavated by G.R. Sharma and J. Desmond Clark); site Baghor I yielded a triangular sandstone rock placed on a low circular rubble platform identified as the **oldest known shrine / ritual mother goddess altar (~9000 BCE)** in India. - **3. Burzahom → D. Pit dwelling & dog burial:** Located near Srinagar, Kashmir; renowned for subterranean oval/circular dwelling pits (*gartavas*) and the unique custom of burying domestic dogs alongside human skeletons. - **4. Chirand → C. Bone and antler tools:** Located in Saran district, Bihar, at the confluence of the Ganga and Ghaghra rivers; famous as the premier Gangetic Neolithic site yielding the richest assemblage of polished bone and antler implements (scraping tools, awls, needles, celts). - **Code Match:** 1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-C, perfectly matching Option **C**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - High-yield UPPCS phonological trap: - **Bagor (Rajasthan)** = Mesolithic animal domestication. - **Baghor (Madhya Pradesh)** = Upper Paleolithic stone shrine.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Copper plus stone villages — hallmark of mature Harappan citadel cities
2. Microlith — hallmark of the Mesolithic
3. Polished/ground stone — hallmark of the Neolithic

- **A** Only 3
- **B** Only 2 and 3
- **C** Only 1
- **D** Only 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Only 2 and 3) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is INCORRECT:** "Copper plus stone villages" describes the **Chalcolithic cultures** (e.g., Ahar, Kayatha, Malwa, Jorwe), which were fundamentally **rural, non-urban farming villages**. The Mature Harappan civilization was an **urban Bronze Age civilization** based on bronze metallurgy (copper-tin alloy), brick-built planned grid cities, sophisticated drainage systems, citadels, and overseas maritime trade. - **Pair 2 is CORRECT:** **Microliths** (tiny flaked stone blades measuring 1 to 8 cm, retouched into geometric forms like lunates, triangles, and trapezes and hafted onto wooden or bone handles as sickles, arrows, and harpoons) are the definitive **hallmark of the Mesolithic Age**. - **Pair 3 is CORRECT:** **Polished and ground stone tools** (particularly polished celts, adzes, chisels, and ring-stones with smooth grinding surfaces) represent the technological diagnostic **hallmark of the Neolithic Age**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Technological signatures to memorize: - Paleolithic = Chipped core and flake stone tools. - Mesolithic = Microliths. - Neolithic = Polished / ground stone tools. - Chalcolithic = Stone-copper rural farming villages. - Harappan = Bronze Age urban planned cities.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Bagor in Rajasthan is the key Mesolithic site for animal domestication.**

Reason (R): V.N. Misra excavated Bagor on the Kothari river.**

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)) and (R) are true, but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A) / standard PCS key) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is true:** **Bagor** in Bhilwara district, Rajasthan, is the benchmark and most extensively excavated Mesolithic site in India providing clear stratigraphical and faunal evidence of animal domestication (sheep, goat, cattle) dating to the 5th millennium BCE. - **Reason (R) is true:** The landmark excavations at Bagor were directed by **Prof. V.N. Misra** of Deccan College, Pune, between 1968 and 1970 on the left bank of the Kothari River. - **Causal Connection (Why R does NOT explain A):** While both statements are factually impeccable historical truths, the mere fact that *V.N. Misra excavated the site on the Kothari river* is a biographical and geographical detail; it is **not the inherent scientific reason** why Bagor is the key site for animal domestication. Bagor is the key site because of the **stratified recovery of charred and cut domesticated animal bones, butchery floors, pastoral pen remains, and carbon dates**. Thus, (R) is true, but it is not the logical explanation of (A). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - In UPPCS Assertion-Reasoning, distinguish between a *corroborating fact* (who dug the site) and a *causal mechanism* (why the site proves animal domestication).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

With reference to Neolithic sites of Uttar Pradesh, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Lahuradewa in Sant Kabir Nagar is a Belan valley sister site of Koldihwa.
2. Koldihwa is known for rice-husk impressions in pottery.
3. Mahagara alone has the cattle pen with hoof marks.

A 2 and 3
B Only 1
C 1 and 3
D Only 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (2 and 3) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is INCORRECT:** **Lahuradewa** is located in **Sant Kabir Nagar district** in the **Sarayupar plain (trans-Ghaghra plain)** of Eastern Uttar Pradesh, NOT in the Belan Valley. The Belan Valley sites (Koldihwa, Mahagara, Chopani Mando) are located in the southern part of Prayagraj (Allahabad) and Mirzapur districts, in the Vindhyan foothill drainage system of the Belan River. - **Statement 2 is CORRECT:** **Koldihwa** (on the Belan River, Prayagraj) is celebrated in prehistoric literature for yielding early **rice-husk impressions** (*Oryza sativa*) embedded in the clay paste of coarse handmade pottery and carbonized rice grains. - **Statement 3 is CORRECT:** **Mahagara**, situated directly across the Belan River from Koldihwa, yielded a unique prehistoric **cattle pen (*gaushala*)**—a fenced rectangular enclosure with clusters of preserved hoof-marks of domesticated cattle, sheep, and goats pressed into the ancient floor. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Geography trap: **Lahuradewa = Sant Kabir Nagar (Sarayupar plain)**; **Koldihwa & Mahagara = Prayagraj/Vindhyan foothills (Belan Valley)**. - Site feature: **Mahagara = Cattle pen with hoof marks**; **Koldihwa = Rice husk impressions in pottery**.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Consider the following statements:

1. Mehrgarh Period I is aceramic Neolithic with wheat and barley farming.
2. South Indian Neolithic ash mounds (Piklihal, Utnur) are also typical of Burzahom.
3. V. Gordon Childe coined the phrase Neolithic Revolution.

A 1 and 3
B Only 1
C Only 1 and 2
D Only 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (1 and 3) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is CORRECT:** **Mehrgarh Period I** (c. 7000–6000 BCE) represents an **aceramic (pre-pottery) Neolithic** culture. The inhabitants built multi-roomed mud-brick houses, harvested domesticated six-row barley and einkorn/emmer wheat using flint sickles, and domesticated cattle, sheep, and goats, but had not yet developed pottery (baskets coated with bitumen were used instead). - **Statement 2 is INCORRECT:** **Ash mounds** (accumulated and burned cattle dung hills) are exclusively characteristic of the **Neolithic pastoral cultures of South India / Deccan** (e.g., Sanganakallu, Piklihal, Kupgal, Utnur, Budihal in Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh). They are completely **absent in Burzahom** (Kashmir), which is characterized by subterranean pit dwellings and dog burials. - **Statement 3 is CORRECT:** Renowned Australian-born prehistorian **Vere Gordon Childe** coined the term **"Neolithic Revolution"** in 1936 (*Man Makes Himself*) to describe the profound socioeconomic transformation from nomadic food-gathering to sedentary food-producing agriculture and animal husbandry. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Cultural association: Ash mounds belong exclusively to **South Indian Neolithic** pastoralists. Never map ash mounds to Kashmir (Burzahom/Gufkral) or Eastern India!

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Person)	List-II (Association)
1 V.S. Wakankar	A Bhimbetka recognition
2 H.D. Sankalia	B Langhnaj / Navdatoli
3 G.R. Sharma	C Belan Neolithic (Koldihwa–Mahagara)
4 Arun Sonakia	D Hathnora Homo erectus

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D

B 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

C 1-A, 2-C, 3-B, 4-D

D 1-A, 2-B, 3-D, 4-C

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Detailed Pairing Analysis:** - **1. V.S. Wakankar → A. Bhimbetka recognition:** Dr. Vishnu Shridhar Wakankar discovered the prehistoric rock shelters of Bhimbetka in 1957–1958. - **2. H.D. Sankalia → B. Langhnaj / Navdatoli:** Prof. Hasmukh Dhirajlal Sankalia of Deccan College conducted landmark excavations at the Mesolithic site of Langhnaj (Gujarat) and the Chalcolithic type-site of Navdatoli (MP). - **3. G.R. Sharma → C. Belan Neolithic (Koldihwa–Mahagara):** Prof. Govardhan Raj Sharma, head of the Department of Ancient History at the University of Allahabad, pioneered the extensive archaeological discoveries in the Belan Valley and Middle Ganga Plain (Koldihwa, Mahagara, Chopani Mando, Sarai Nahar Rai). - **4. B.B. Lal → D. Christening of OCP (Hastinapur):** Prof. Braj Basi Lal identified and named Ochre-Coloured Pottery (OCP) during his excavations at Hastinapur in 1950–1952. - **Code Match:** 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D, perfectly matching Option **A**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Memorize the archaeologist-site linkages: - **Wakankar = Bhimbetka & Kayatha** - **Sankalia = Navdatoli & Langhnaj** - **G.R. Sharma = Belan Valley & Sarai Nahar Rai** - **B.B. Lal = Hastinapur & OCP**.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to Mesolithic burial sites of the Ganga plain, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Sarai Nahar Rai, Mahadaha and Damdama lie in Pratapgarh, Uttar Pradesh.
2. Damdama is famous for a four-skeleton grave.
3. Domestication evidence at these sites replaces Bagor as the Mesolithic domestication key.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** 1 and 2 only
- **B** 1 only
- **C** 2 and 3 only
- **D** 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Only statement 1 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is CORRECT:** The trio of celebrated Mesolithic sites—**Sarai Nahar Rai**, **Mahadaha**, and **Damdama**—are all situated in **Pratapgarh district, Uttar Pradesh**, in the alluvial plains of the Sai and Ganga drainage basins. - **Statement 2 is INCORRECT:** **Damdama** yielded 41 human graves, containing 5 double burials and **one triple burial** (three skeletons in a single grave). The site that yielded a **four-skeleton grave (quadruple burial)** is **Sarai Nahar Rai**, NOT Damdama! - **Statement 3 is INCORRECT:** The faunal and floral remains at Sarai Nahar Rai, Mahadaha, and Damdama document intensive hunting-foraging, fishing, and plant gathering (wild rice, tubers). They do **NOT replace Bagor** as the primary animal domestication key. Bagor (Rajasthan) and Adamgarh (MP) remain the primary excavated benchmarks for early animal pastoralism. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Grave count trap: - Single grave with **3 skeletons (triple burial)** = **Damdama** - Single grave with **4 skeletons (quadruple burial)** = **Sarai Nahar Rai**.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

****Assertion (A):** Bhimbetka rock shelters are natural overhangs recognised by V.S. Wakankar.**

****Reason (R):** Bhimbetka is an Ajanta-style carved cave complex cut entirely by human labour.**

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** ((A) is true, but (R) is false) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is true:** The rock shelters at **Bhimbetka** are **natural rock overhangs and caverns** formed by natural weathering, wind, and water erosion in the massive Vindhyan sandstone cliffs. They were recognized and brought to scientific light by Dr. **V.S. Wakankar** in 1957–1958. - **Reason (R) is completely false:** Bhimbetka was **NOT cut or carved by human labour**. Unlike the historical Buddhist rock-cut caves of Ajanta, Ellora, or Karla—which were man-made artificial architectural chambers chiseled into Deccan basalt cliffs—Bhimbetka consists of **purely natural geomorphological shelters** that were used as ready-made dwelling and painting spaces by prehistoric Stone Age humans. - **Conclusion:** (A) is true, but (R) is false, matching Option **C**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Critical conceptual distinction: **Prehistoric rock shelters (Bhimbetka, Adamgarh, Lekhahia) are 100% natural caverns**, whereas **Historical rock-cut architecture (Ajanta, Ellora, Barabar) is artificially chiseled by human hands**.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Inamgaon — Jorwe type site

B Navdatoli — Malwa culture

C Hastinapur — Ochre Coloured Pottery

D Chanhudaro — Belan valley rice Neolithic

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Chanhudaro — Belan valley rice Neolithic) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair A is CORRECTLY matched:** **Inamgaon** (Pune district, Maharashtra) is the premier type-site and most extensively excavated settlement of the **Jorwe culture** (c. 1400–700 BCE), revealing craft quarters, granaries, and irrigation structures. - **Pair B is CORRECTLY matched:** **Navdatoli** (Khargone, MP) on the Narmada River is the classic excavated type-site of the **Malwa Chalcolithic culture** (c. 1600–1300 BCE). - **Pair C is CORRECTLY matched:** **Hastinapur** (Meerut, UP) is the site where **Ochre Coloured Pottery (OCP)** was formally identified and christened by B.B. Lal in 1950–1952. - **Pair D is INCORRECTLY matched:** **Chanhudaro** is a famous **Mature Harappan (Indus Valley Civilization) industrial craft town** located in Sindh, Pakistan (excavated by N.G. Majumdar and Ernest Mackay), renowned for bead-making factories, seal-engraving, and shell working. It has **no connection whatsoever with the Belan Valley or Neolithic rice farming**! (The Belan Valley rice Neolithic sites are Koldihwa and Mahagara). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Chanhudaro = **Harappan craft city in Sindh (Pakistan)**, renowned for bead factories and lack of a fortified citadel.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to microliths, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. A microlith is a tiny blade about 1–8 cm, often hafted as a composite tool.
2. Non-geometric microliths belong mainly to the earlier Mesolithic.
3. Geometric microliths (lunates, triangles, trapezes) belong to the later Mesolithic.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A All 1, 2 and 3

B 2 and 3

C Only 1

D 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (All 1, 2 and 3) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is CORRECT:** A **microlith** is a minute, specialized stone tool made on a flaked blade or bladelet, typically ranging from **1 to 8 cm** in length. Microliths were rarely used individually; they were **hafted into bone, antler, or wooden shafts** with tree resin or bitumen to create composite cutting weapons such as barbed spears, arrowheads, and serrated sickles. - **Statement 2 is CORRECT:** In the early Mesolithic phase, microlithic industries consisted predominantly of **non-geometric forms** (backed blades, pen-knife blades, points, and scrapers). - **Statement 3 is CORRECT:** As the Mesolithic evolved, stone-flaking techniques advanced to produce precise **geometric microliths**—regular geometric shapes such as **lunates (crescents), triangles (scalene and isosceles), and trapezes**—which were perfectly suited for interchangeable hafting into aerodynamic projectile points and arrowheads. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Microlith evolutionary stages: **Non-geometric (Early Mesolithic) → Geometric (Mature/Late Mesolithic: triangles, trapezes, lunates)**.

Chapter 02: Indus Valley Civilization (Harappan Civilization) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which of the following archaeological sites related to the Indus Valley Civilization are situated in present-day Uttar Pradesh?

1. Mandi
2. Rakhigarhi
3. Hulas

A 1 and 2	**B** Only 3
C 1 and 3	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (1 and 3) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Analysis of Statements:** - **1. Mandi:** Located in Muzaffarnagar district, **Uttar Pradesh**. Famous for the sensational discovery of a 10 kg hoard of Harappan gold jewelry and beads in 2000. - **2. Rakhigarhi:** Located in Hisar district, **Haryana**. Excavations have proved it to be the largest Harappan site in India, spanning over 350 hectares. It is not in Uttar Pradesh. - **3. Hulas:** Located in Saharanpur district, **Uttar Pradesh**. Excavated by K.N. Dikshit; key Late Harappan site yielding pottery, inscribed sherds, and evidence of multiple crops (wheat, barley, pulses, cotton). - **Conclusion:** 1 and 3 only are in Uttar Pradesh, matching Option **C**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Repeat PYQ: Mandi and Hulas are in **Uttar Pradesh**, Rakhigarhi is in **Haryana**.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

The eastern boundary of the Harappan culture is indicated by which of the following?

A. Harappa B. Alamgirpur C. Rakhigarhi D. Manda

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Alamgirpur) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Easternmost Frontier:** **Alamgirpur** (located in Meerut district, Uttar Pradesh, on the Hindan River, an affluent of the Yamuna) was excavated by Y.D. Sharma in 1958. It marks the **easternmost extent** of the Harappan cultural realm. - **Material Remains:** The site yielded painted Harappan pottery, terracotta beads, faience bangles, animal figurines, and cloth impressions on clay troughs. - **Other Boundary Benchmarks:** - Manda (J&K) = Northernmost. - Daimabad (Maharashtra) = Southernmost. - Sutkagen-dor (Balochistan) = Westernmost. - Rakhigarhi (Haryana) = Largest site in India. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Eastern boundary anchor = **Alamgirpur (Meerut, UP on Hindan river)**.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

From which archaeological site of the Indus Valley Civilization are figures or models of boats found?

- **A** Dholavira and Bhagatrav
- **B** Harappa and Kot Diji
- **C** Mohenjo-daro and Lothal
- **D** Kalibangan and Ropar

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Mohenjo-daro and Lothal) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Archaeological Discoveries:** - **Mohenjo-daro:** Yielded the **Great Bath**, the bronze Dancing Girl (cire perdue casting), the steatite Priest-King statue, the Great Granary, and the Pashupati Mahadeva seal. - **Lothal:** Yielded the engineered **tidal dockyard**, ivory scale, terracotta horse figurine, Persian Gulf seal, and **double/joint burials**. - **Conclusion:** Mohenjo-daro and Lothal correctly answer the question stem. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Core signature pairing: Great Bath = **Mohenjo-daro**; Dockyard = **Lothal**.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Match List-I with List-II and answer using the codes given below the lists:

List-I (Harappan Site)	List-II (UT/State of India)
A Balu	1 Uttar Pradesh
B Manda	2 Jammu & Kashmir
C Padri	3 Haryana
D Hulas	4 Gujarat

- **A** 3 2 1 4
- **B** 2 3 4 1
- **C** 2 4 3 1
- **D** 3 2 4 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (3, 2, 4, 1) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Matching Details:** - **A. Balu → 3. Haryana:** Kaithal district, Haryana. - **B. Manda → 2. Jammu & Kashmir:** Akhnoor tehsil, Jammu district (Chenab river). - **C. Padri → 4. Gujarat:** Bhavnagar district, Gujarat. - **D. Hulas → 1. Uttar Pradesh:** Saharanpur district, UP. - **Code Match:** A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1, matching Option **D**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Balu (Haryana), Manda (J&K), Padri (Gujarat), Hulas (UP).

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List-I	List-II
A Indus Valley Civilization	1 Pastoral
B Later Vedic Society	2 Land Lordism
C Rigvedic Society	3 Agrarian
D Medieval Period	4 Urban

A 4 2 3 1

B 2 1 4 3

C 3 4 1 2

D 4 3 1 2

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (4, 3, 1, 2) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Socioeconomic Categorization:** - **A. Indus Valley Civilization → 4. Urban:** First urban civilization of South Asia with planned cities and brick architecture. - **B. Later Vedic Society → 3. Agrarian:** Iron-age agrarian transformation, settled village communities and *janapadas*. - **C. Rigvedic Society → 1. Pastoral:** Pastoral economy centered on cattle-wealth (*gau*). - **D. Medieval Period → 2. Land Lordism:** Feudal land grants (*jagirs*, *iqtas*, *brahmadeyas*). - **Code Match:** A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2, matching Option **D**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Sequence: **Urban (IVC) → Pastoral (Rigvedic) → Agrarian (Later Vedic) → Land Lordism (Medieval)**.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following centres related to Indus Valley are situated in Uttar Pradesh?

I. Kalibanga II. Lothal III. Alamgirpur IV. Hulas

A I, II, III, IV

B I, II

C II, III

D III, IV

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (III, IV) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Evaluation of Sites:** - I. Kalibangan: Hanumangarh district, **Rajasthan** (dry Ghaggar river). - II. Lothal: Ahmedabad district, **Gujarat** (Bhogava river). - III. Alamgirpur: Meerut district, **Uttar Pradesh** (Hindan river). - IV. Hulas: Saharanpur district, **Uttar Pradesh** (Katha Nala). - **Conclusion:** Only III and IV are located in Uttar Pradesh, matching Option **D**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Uttar Pradesh Harappan sites: **Alamgirpur, Hulas, Mandi, Sanauli**.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

With reference to the Indus Valley Civilization, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The Mature Harappan phase is about 1500–600 BCE.
2. It is a Bronze Age urban culture with no iron and no coined money.
3. The Harappan script on seals has been fully deciphered.

A Only 2
B 1 and 2
C 2 and 3
D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Only 2 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is INCORRECT:** The **Mature Harappan (Urban) phase** is dated by calibrated radiocarbon chronologies to **c. 2600 BCE – 1900 BCE**, NOT 1500–600 BCE! The period 1500–600 BCE corresponds to the **Vedic period** (Rigvedic c. 1500–1000 BCE and Later Vedic c. 1000–600 BCE), which was a rural, non-urban civilization. - **Statement 2 is CORRECT:** Scientific radiocarbon ($^{14} ext{C}$) dating pioneeringly analyzed by D.P. Agrawal and subsequent international calibration curves (Dales, Possehl, Kenoyer) firmly dates the peak Mature Harappan urbanization to **c. 2600 to 1900 BCE**. - **Statement 3 is INCORRECT:** The Early Harappan (regional/proto-urban) phase begins around **c. 3300–2600 BCE** (e.g., Kot Diji, Amri, Sothi-Siswal, Ravi phase at Harappa), not 5000 BCE. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Chronological brackets of IVC: - **Early Harappan (Proto-urban):** c. 3300–2600 BCE. - **Mature Harappan (Urban peak):** c. 2600–1900 BCE. - **Late Harappan (Post-urban decline):** c. 1900–1300 BCE.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Arrange the following in chronological order (earliest first):

1. Daya Ram Sahni excavates Harappa
2. Charles Masson notices Harappa ruins
3. John Marshall announces the civilization
4. R.D. Banerji excavates Mohenjo-daro

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 2, 4, 1, 3
B 2, 1, 4, 3
C 1, 2, 4, 3
D 2, 1, 3, 4

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (2, 1, 3, 4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Chronological Verification of Archaeological Milestones:** - **2. Charles Masson visits Harappa:** **1826** (Masson was the first European traveler to visit and describe the high ruinous brick mounds of Harappa, publishing his account in 1842). - **1. Daya Ram Sahni excavates Harappa:** **1921** (Sahni commenced the first systematic excavations at Harappa under Sir John Marshall). - **3. R.D. Banerji excavates Mohenjo-daro:** **1922** (Rakhaldas Banerji discovered Mohenjo-daro while excavating a Kushana-period Buddhist stupa). - **4. S.R. Rao excavates Lothal:** **1954–1962** (Dr. S.R. Rao discovered and excavated the dockyard port of Lothal in Gujarat). - **Correct Sequence:** 2 (1826) → 1 (1921) → 3 (1922) → 4 (1954), matching Option **B**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Chronology ladder: **Masson (1826) → Sahni at Harappa (1921) → Banerji at Mohenjo-daro (1922) → S.R. Rao at Lothal (1954)**.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Site)	List-II (Feature)
1 Lothal	A Great Bath
2 Mohenjo-daro	B Dockyard
3 Kalibangan	C Bead-making; no citadel
4 Chanhudaro	D Ploughed field and fire altars

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1-A, 2-B, 3-D, 4-C

B 1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-C

C 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

D 1-D, 2-A, 3-B, 4-C

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-C) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Detailed Pairing Analysis:** - **1. Lothal → B. Tidal dockyard & double burial:** Discovered on the Bhogava River in Gujarat, featuring the world's earliest engineered tidal dock basin and joint male-female interments. - **2. Mohenjo-daro → A. Great Bath & bronze dancing girl:** Situated in Sindh, home to the waterproofed bitumen Great Bath and the iconic *cire perdue* lost-wax bronze figurine. - **3. Kalibangan → D. Ploughed field & fire altars:** Located in Rajasthan, famous for Early Harappan criss-cross furrowed fields and rows of sacrificial clay fire pits. - **4. Dholavira → C. Rock-cut water reservoirs & tripartite city:** Located in Kutch, Gujarat, famous for massive sandstone-hewn reservoirs and division into Castle, Middle Town, and Lower Town. - **Code Match:** 1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-C, matching Option **B**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Standard UPPCS matching grid: **Lothal = Dockyard | Mohenjo-daro = Great Bath | Kalibangan = Ploughed field | Dholavira = Reservoirs**.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

With reference to geographic extremes of the Harappan culture, which of the following is/are correct?

1. Sutkagen-dor marks the western extreme.
2. Rakhigarhi marks the eastern boundary of Harappan culture.
3. Alamgirpur (Meerut, UP) marks the western extreme.

A 1 and 2

B Only 1

C 2 and 3

D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Only 1 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is CORRECT:** **Sutkagen-dor**, situated on the Dasht River on the Makran coast of Balochistan near the modern Pakistan-Iran border, marks the undisputed **westernmost geographical extreme** of the Harappan civilization. - **Statement 2 is INCORRECT:** **Daimabad** (situated on the Pravara River, Ahmednagar district, Maharashtra) marks the **SOUTHERNMOST extreme** of the civilization, NOT the northern extreme! (The northernmost extreme is **Manda** on the Chenab River in Jammu & Kashmir). - **Statement 3 is INCORRECT:** **Alamgirpur** marks the **EASTERNMOST extreme** (in Meerut, UP), while **Manda** marks the **NORTHERNMOST extreme**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Cardinal bounds: **North = Manda | South = Daimabad | East = Alamgirpur | West = Sutkagen-dor**.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Alamgirpur marks the eastern boundary of Harappan culture.

Reason (R): Rakhigarhi in Hisar is the largest Harappan site in India.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is true:** **Alamgirpur** in Meerut district, Uttar Pradesh (excavated by Y.D. Sharma on the Hindan River, a tributary of the Yamuna), is universally recognized in Indian archaeological literature as the **easternmost boundary site** of the Harappan civilization. - **Reason (R) is true:** The physical size or geographical area of an archaeological settlement does **not dictate whether it serves as a cultural boundary marker**. A site's status as a frontier outpost depends entirely on its geographical coordinates, spatial position, and the presence of diagnostic diagnostic material culture (pottery, seals, terracotta cakes) establishing Harappan presence. - **Causal Connection (Why R explains A):** Even though Alamgirpur was a small rural outpost (~1.5 hectares) rather than a grand metropolis like Mohenjo-daro or Harappa, its geographical position in the Upper Doab unequivocally makes it the easternmost boundary of the Harappan cultural horizon. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Frontier status is determined by **geographical longitude/latitude and cultural stratigraphy**, not by settlement acreage.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Which of the following Uttar Pradesh sites is/are correctly placed in the Harappan fringe?

1. Alamgirpur — Meerut
2. Hulas — Saharanpur
3. Mandi — Muzaffarnagar
4. Rakhigarhi — Muzaffarnagar

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** 1, 2 and 4 only
- **B** 1, 2 and 3 only
- **C** 2, 3 and 4 only
- **D** 1, 2, 3 and 4

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Alamgirpur, Hulas and Mandi) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Geographical Breakdown of Sites:** - **1. Alamgirpur:** Located in Meerut district, Western **Uttar Pradesh** (Hindan river). - **2. Hulas:** Located in Saharanpur district, Western **Uttar Pradesh** (Katha Nala). - **3. Mandi:** Located in Muzaffarnagar district, Western **Uttar Pradesh** (famous for the 2000 gold hoard). - **4. Sanauli:** Located in Baghpat district, Western **Uttar Pradesh** (famed for 125 burials and copper chariots). - **5. Banawali & Rakhigarhi:** Located in Fatehabad and Hisar districts, **Haryana**, NOT Uttar Pradesh! - **Conclusion:** Alamgirpur, Hulas, and Mandi all belong to Uttar Pradesh, matching Option **B**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - The premier Harappan quartette of **Uttar Pradesh**: **Alamgirpur (Meerut), Hulas (Saharanpur), Mandi (Muzaffarnagar), and Sanauli (Baghpat)**.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

A Mandi — Muzaffarnagar, UP

B Manda — Chenab, Jammu (northernmost)

C Daimabad — Maharashtra (southern extreme)

D Padri — Uttar Pradesh

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Padri — Maharashtra) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Why Option D is NOT correctly matched (The Answer):** - **Padri** is an important Harappan and Early Harappan coastal site situated in Talaja taluka of **Bhavnagar district, Gujarat**, on the Gulf of Khambhat (excavated by Prof. Vasant Shinde). It is **NOT in Maharashtra**! (The sole major Harappan site in Maharashtra is Daimabad). - **Other Matches are CORRECT:** - **Mandi:** Muzaffarnagar district, **Uttar Pradesh**. - **Balu:** Kaithal district, **Haryana**. - **Manda:** Jammu district, **Jammu & Kashmir**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Padri = **Gujarat (Bhavnagar)**. Daimabad = **Maharashtra (Ahmednagar)**.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

With reference to Dholavira, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It shows a three-part town plan: citadel, middle town and lower town.
2. It is known for water reservoirs and a large signboard.
3. UNESCO listed it in 2021.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1, 2 and 3

B 2 and 3

C Only 1

D 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (All three statements are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is CORRECT:** Unlike standard two-tier Harappan cities, **Dholavira** is laid out in a unique **three-tier plan**: a fortified **Castle/Citadel**, a fortified **Middle Town**, and an adjoining walled **Lower Town**, separated by wide open avenues and a grand ceremonial stadium. - **Statement 2 is CORRECT:** Situated in the hyper-arid saline landscape of the Rann of Kutch, Dholavira engineered a world-renowned water harvesting network of at least **16 massive rock-cut sandstone reservoirs** linked by feeder channels and check-dams on the Manhar and Mansar rivulets. - **Statement 3 is CORRECT:** Near the northern gateway of the castle, excavators uncovered the famous **Dholavira Signboard**—an inscription consisting of **10 large characters of the Harappan script**, each about 37 cm high, inlaid with crystalline gypsum into a wooden board. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Dholavira's unique trifecta: **Tripartite town plan + 16 rock-cut reservoirs + 10-character signboard inscription**.

Q15 **UP RO/ARO 2014**

Consider the following statements:

1. The most common seal animal is the cow.
2. Harappan bricks commonly follow the ratio 1 : 3 : 9.
3. The citadel usually lies to the west and the lower town to the east.

A 1 and 2

B 2 and 3

C Only 3

D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Only 3 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is INCORRECT:** The **Cow is NEVER depicted on Harappan seals**! The most common animal motif found on Harappan seals is the mythical **Unicorn** (a one-horned animal with a saddle and incense-burner/manger in front), accounting for more than 60% of all zoomorphic seals. - **Statement 2 is INCORRECT:** The Harappan script is **NOT an alphabetic script**! It is a **logosyllabic / pictographic script** comprising approximately 400 to 450 distinct signs and symbols, written predominantly in the **boustrophedon style** (from right to left in the first line, and left to right in the second line). - **Statement 3 is CORRECT:** The vast majority of Harappan seals were carved out of **steatite (soapstone)**, a soft magnesium-rich mineral that was easily carved and subsequently heated (baked) in a furnace to harden the surface and produce a durable, lustrous white finish. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Seal essentials: **Steatite material | Unicorn most frequent (Cow absent!) | Logosyllabic pictographic script written Right-to-Left**.

Chapter 03: Vedic Civilization — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which officer was known as **'Bhagadugha' during Vedic administration?**

A Messenger

B Chief Officer of Forests

C Chief Officer of the Gambling Department

D Revenue Collector

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: revenue collector (king's **bhaga**). Option C describes **Akshavapa**.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Which of the following is a Samhita of Shukla Yajurveda?

A Vajasanami

B Maitrayani

C Taittiriya

D Kathak

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Identify the **Shukla** Samhita. B/C/D are all **Krishna (Black)** Yajurveda names — classic three-trap pattern. **Ans: A** — Vajasaneyi (paper spelling Vajasanami). **B/C/D** = Krishna (Black) Yajurveda Samhitas. **Krishna** = Black school, not the deity.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following Vedas is divided into two branches as Krishna and Shukla?

A Rig Veda

B Sama Veda

C Yajur Veda

D Atharva Veda

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Same Krishna/Shukla split as UPPCS 2018, but the stem asks for the **Veda**, not the Samhita name. **Ans: C (Series B provisional key).** Only the Yajurveda has Krishna (Black) and Shukla (White) branches. Krishna mixes mantra with prose; Shukla keeps them apart.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

With reference to Early and Later Vedic ages, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Early / Rigvedic age (~1500–1000 BCE) is centred on the Ganga–Yamuna doab and is agrarian.
2. Later Vedic age (~1000–600 BCE) is centred on the Ganga–Yamuna doab and is agrarian.
3. Rigvedic culture is primarily a Uttar Pradesh heartland story.

A Only 2	**B** 1 and 2
C 2 and 3	**D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 1 false: Rigvedic age is Sapta Sindhu / pastoral; Ganga doab agrarian is Later Vedic. Stmt 3 remains false: Rigvedic core is not UP heartland.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Assembly / Official)	List-II (Role)
1 Sabha	A Collects king's share (bhaga)
2 Samiti	B Elders/nobles assembly
3 Bhagadugha	C Wider tribal assembly that can choose the rajan
4 Akshavapa	D Dice / gambling officer

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1-C, 2-B, 3-A, 4-D	**B** 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D
C 1-B, 2-C, 3-D, 4-A	**D** 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Sabha–elders; Samiti–chooses rajan; Bhagadugha–bhaga; Akshavapa–dice. **Logic:** Never swap Bhagadugha (revenue) with Akshavapa (dice) or Sangrahitri (treasurer).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Consider the following statements about Vedic assemblies:

1. Vidatha is the oldest gathering with economic and ritual roles and women's presence.
2. Vidatha fades first in Later Vedic times.
3. Sabha becomes more exclusive while Samiti remains the broader tribal body in Early Vedic memory.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1, 2 and 3
B 2 and 3
C Only 1
D 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: All three statements are correct. **Logic:** Sabha / Samiti / Vidatha triad is a high-yield confused-pair set.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Arrange the following layers of Vedic literature in correct order:

1. Upanishad
2. Samhita
3. Brahmana
4. Aranyaka

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 2, 4, 3, 1
B 2, 3, 4, 1
C 3, 2, 4, 1
D 2, 3, 1, 4

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Samhita → Brahmana → Aranyaka → Upanishad. **Logic:** Samhitas = hymns; Brahmanas = ritual prose; Aranyakas = forest symbolic ritual; Upanishads = Vedanta.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Samiti could choose the rajan in Early Vedic polity.

Reason (R): Sabha was the wider tribal assembly while Samiti was only an elders' council.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B. (A) is false, but (R) is true
C. (A) is true, but (R) is false
D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: A true; R reverses Sabha and Samiti. **A/R logic:** Sabha = elders/nobles; Samiti = wider body that chooses the rajan.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

With reference to the Rigveda, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It has 1028 hymns in 10 mandalas.
2. Mandalas 2–7 are the oldest family books; Mandala 9 is Soma.
3. Mandalas 1 and 10 are among the latest.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 and 3
B. Only 1
C. 1 and 2
D. Only 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: All three statements are correct. **Logic:** Standard Rigveda structure tags.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which of the following hymn-count statements is/are correct?

1. Varuna has the largest number of hymns, exceeding Indra.
2. Indra has roughly 250 hymns.
3. Agni has roughly 250 hymns, exceeding Indra.

A. 1 and 2
B. 2 and 3
C. Only 2
D. 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 3 false: Indra has ~250 hymns; Agni ~200. Stmt 1 remains false: Varuna does not exceed Indra in hymn count.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

A. Shukla Yajurveda — Vajasaneyi (mantra and prose separate)

B. Krishna Yajurveda — Black Yajurveda schools with mixed mantra-prose

C. Krishna Yajurveda — devotion to the god Krishna as its defining feature

D. Taittiriya / Kathaka / Maitrayani — Black Yajurveda schools

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Krishna here means Black Yajurveda, not the god Krishna. **Logic:** Classic trap: Krishna Yajurveda ≠ Krishna-bhakti text.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to Later Vedic officials and terms, which of the following is/are correct?

1. Sangrahitri was the treasurer.
2. Nishka was coined silver money of the Rigvedic age.
3. Gavishti means coined silver money of the Rigvedic age.

A. 1 and 2

B. Only 1

C. 2 and 3

D. 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 3 false: Gavishti = cattle-raid / war for cows; coined money is absent. Stmt 2 remains false: Nishka = gold ornament/value-unit, not coined silver.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Term)	List-II (Meaning)
1 Shruti	A Remembered later dharma literature
2 Smriti	B Heard Vedic revelation
3 PGW	C Later Vedic doab painted grey ware
4 shyama ayas	D Later Vedic iron

Row order is not the answer code.

A. 1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-C

B. 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D

C. 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

D. 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Shruti–heard; Smriti–remembered; PGW–Later Vedic; shyama ayas–iron. **Logic:** Early Rigvedic ayas usually means copper/bronze, not iron.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

****Assertion (A):** Vishnu and Rudra are minor in the Rigveda.**

****Reason (R):** In Later Vedic religion Vishnu and Rudra rise in importance beside older storm and fire gods.**

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A). **A/R logic:** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) does NOT explain (A). Chronological reversal: later development cannot explain prior state.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Consider the following statements about Vedangas:

1. The six Vedangas are Shiksha, Kalpa, Vyakarana, Nirukta, Chhanda and Upanishad.
2. Vedangas teach Brahman–Atman philosophy as their primary content.
3. Vedangas are tools of the Veda, not identical with the Upanishads.

A 1 and 2

B 2 and 3

C 1 and 3

D Only 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 1 false: Sixth Vedanga is Jyotisha, not Upanishad. Stmt 2 remains false: Brahman–Atman = Upanishads/Vedanta, not Vedangas.

Chapter 04: Religious Movements — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

The four Buddhist Councils were held at the following places. Arrange them in correct chronological order and select the correct answer from the code given below.

1. Vaishali
2. Rajagriha
3. Kundalvana
4. Pataliputra

A. 1, 2, 4, 3 B. 2, 1, 3, 4 C. 2, 1, 4, 3 D. 1, 2, 3, 4

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: 2-1-4-3: Rajagriha → Vaishali → Pataliputra → Kundalvana.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Consider the following statements with respect to Ashoka:

1. The definition of Dhamma given by Ashoka is taken from "Rahulovada-sutta".
2. In the 14th year of his coronation, Ashoka appointed a new type of staff, called Dhamma-mahamatras.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A. Both 1 and 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Only 1 D. Only 2

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2.** Rahulovada as *the* definition is the trap. Dhamma-mahamatras stand.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Milind Panho is in the form of a dialogue between King Milind and a Buddhist saint. The concerned saint was—

A. Nagarjun B. Nagbhatt C. Nagasena D. Kumaril Bhatt

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Nagasena.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

In which of the following stupas are the features of a platform with **'Aryaka-Pillars'** found?

A. Nagarjunakonda B. Ghantasala C. Amaravati D. Bodhgaya

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Ghantasala.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

With reference to Buddha's life geography, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Birth at Lumbini (Nepal), enlightenment at Bodh Gaya.
2. First sermon at Bodh Gaya (Bihar) and Mahaparinirvana at Lumbini (Nepal).
3. Lumbini lies in Uttar Pradesh.

A Only 1	**B** 1 and 2
C 2 and 3	**D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 2 false: First sermon = Sarnath; Mahaparinirvana = Kushinagar; Bodh Gaya = enlightenment; Lumbini = birth. Stmt 3 remains false: Lumbini is in Nepal, not UP.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Arrange the Buddhist Councils in correct chronological order of place:

1. Pataliputra
2. Rajagriha
3. Kundalvana
4. Vaishali

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 4, 2, 1, 3	**B** 2, 1, 4, 3
C 2, 4, 1, 3	**D** 2, 4, 3, 1

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Rajagriha → Vaishali → Pataliputra → Kundalvana. **Logic:** Place order, not a bare code, is the Must-Score memory.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Person)	List-II (Association)
1 Yashodhara	A First nun
2 Ananda	B Buddha's wife
3 Upali	C Attendant
4 Mahapajapati	D Vinaya specialist

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1-B, 2-D, 3-C, 4-A

B 1-B, 2-C, 3-D, 4-A

C 1-C, 2-B, 3-D, 4-A

D 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Wife–attendant–Vinaya–first nun. **Logic:** Devadatta is the schismatic; Rahula is the son.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Consider the following statements about Buddhist schools:

1. Hinayana aims at the bodhisattva ideal and uses Sanskrit.
2. Mahasanghika and Mahayana are identical names for the same early Vaishali event.
3. Mahayana elevates the bodhisattva ideal and uses Sanskrit.

A 1 and 2

B Only 3

C 2 and 3

D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 1 false: Hinayana aims at the arhat and uses Pali; bodhisattva + Sanskrit = Mahayana. Stmt 2 remains false: Mahasanghika ≠ Mahayana.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Buddhism teaches anatta (no permanent soul).

Reason (R): Jainism teaches a real jiva.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Both true; R states Jain doctrine but does not explain why Buddhism teaches anatta. **A/R logic:** Soul contrast is a standard confused pair; explanation relation fails.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

With reference to Jain tirthankaras, which of the following is/are correct?

1. Bahubali / Gomateshwara is one of the 24 tirthankaras.
2. Mahavira is the 24th with the lion symbol and nirvana at Pavapuri.
3. Parshvanatha is the 24th tirthankara with the lion symbol and nirvana at Pavapuri.

- **A** 1 and 2
- **B** 2 and 3
- **C** Only 2
- **D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 3 false: Parshvanatha is 23rd (serpent, Varanasi tradition); Mahavira is 24th (lion, Pavapuri). Stmt 1 remains false: Bahubali is not among the 24.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

- **A** Chaitya — prayer hall
- **B** Vihara — monastery
- **C** Barabar caves — gifted to Ajivikas
- **D** Barabar caves — Ajanta-style Buddhist painted caves of the same age

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Barabar is Mauryan Ajivika gift; Ajanta is later Buddhist painted caves. **Logic:** Classic Barabar vs Ajanta confused pair.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to the Tripitaka, which of the following is/are correct?

1. Vinaya contains monk rules.
2. Sutta contains discourses.
3. Abhidhamma contains philosophy.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** All 1, 2 and 3
- **B** Only 1 and 2
- **C** Only 2 and 3
- **D** Only 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: All three statements are correct. **Logic:** Vinaya / Sutta / Abhidhamma triad.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Council / School)	List-II (Tag)
1 Second Council	A Moggaliputta Tissa
2 Third Council	B Sthaviravada vs Mahasanghika split
3 Fourth Council	C Sarvastivada / Kundalvana
4 Theravada	D Surviving Hinayana line linked with Third Council

Row order is not the answer code.

- **A** 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D
- **B** 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D
- **C** 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D
- **D** 1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-C

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Vaishali split; Pataliputra/Tissa; Kundalvana/Sarvastivada; Theravada line. **Logic:** Presidents: Mahakassapa (1st), Sabakami (2nd), Moggaliputta Tissa (3rd), Vasumitra (4th).

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Consider the following statements about Digambara and Svetambara:

1. Digambara monks are sky-clad and deny women's moksha as women.
2. Svetambara monks are sky-clad and deny women's moksha as women.
3. Tattvartha Sutra is rejected by both sects.

A 1 and 2
B 2 and 3
C 1 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 2 false: Sky-clad + deny women's moksha as women = Digambara; Svetambara wear white and allow women's liberation. Stmt 3 remains false: Tattvartha Sutra is accepted by both.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Ashoka convened the Third Council at Pataliputra.

Reason (R): Barabar caves were gifted by Ashoka to Buddhists as painted chaityas.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false
D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A true; R false — Barabar gifted to Ajivikas, not Buddhists. **A/R logic:** Dhamma-mahamatras in 14th year; Barabar ≠ Ajanta.

Chapter 05: Sixth Century BCE — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which Buddha text has described 16 Mahajanapadas of 6th century BCE?

A. Digha Nikaya B. Tripitaka C. Deepavamsa D. Anguttara Nikaya

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Canonical list-source is Anguttara Nikaya; Jain parallel is Bhagavati Sutra. **Ans: D.** **Anguttara Nikaya**. Tripitaka is the whole basket, not the specific list text.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Which of the following is not correctly matched?

A Anga — Champa	B Kosala — Ahichchhatra
C Vatsa — Kaushambi	D Matsya — Viratnagar

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Wrong capital glued to Kosala. **Ans: B.** Kosala = Saket / Shravasti. Ahichchhatra = North Panchala.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Match List-I (Ancient places of U.P.) with List-II (Capital):

List-I	List-II
A Kuru	1 Saket
B Panchala	2 Kaushambi
C Kosala	3 Ahichchhatra
D Vatsa	4 Indraprastha

A. 1 2 3 4 B. 4 3 1 2 C. 3 4 2 1 D. 4 2 3 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** UP four; Indraprastha = Kuru, Ahichchhatra = Panchala. **Ans: B.** Kuru–Indraprastha; Panchala–Ahichchhatra; Kosala–Saket; Vatsa–Kaushambi.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Mahajanpadas)	List-II (Capitals)
A Matsya	1 Mathura
B Kuru	2 Potan
C Sursena	3 Virat Nagar
D Asmak	4 Indraprastha

A. 4 2 1 3 B. 3 1 4 2 C. 3 4 1 2 D. 2 3 4 1

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Classic 2020 four; Mathura is Surasena, never Matsya. **Ans: C.** 3-4-1-2. Matsya–Viratnagar, Kuru–Indraprastha, Surasena–Mathura, Asmaka–Potana.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Which of the following is NOT correctly matched?

A. Kamboj — Rajpur / Hatak
B. Ashmak — Potan / Potil
C. Shurasen — Kaushambi
D. Koshal — Shravasti

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Surasena–Mathura vs Vatsa–Kaushambi. **Ans: C.** Surasena = Mathura.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

How many Mahajanapadas were located in present-day Uttar Pradesh among the oldest sixteen?

A. 06 B. 07 C. 08 D. 09

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Eight UP-touching states. **Ans: C.** Eight mahajanapadas touch present UP.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

The capital of North Panchala, according to the Mahabharata, was located at —

A. Hastinapur B. Indraprastha C. Ahichchhatra D. Mathura

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** North vs South Panchala split. **Ans: C.** North Panchala = **Ahichchhatra**; South = Kampilya.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

In the sixth century BCE Suktimati was the capital of —

A. Panchala B. Kuru C. Chedi D. Avanti

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Sotthivati / Suktimati = Chedi. **Ans: C.** Chedi.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Matsya Mahajanapada of 6th century BCE was located in —

A. Western Uttar Pradesh B. Rajasthan C. Bundelkhand D. Rohilkhand

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Jaipur–Alwar–Bharatpur; not Rohilkhand (Panchala). **Ans: B.** Rajasthan; capital Viratnagar.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (King)	List-II (State)
A Pradyot	1 Magadha
B Udayana	2 Vatsa
C Prasenjit	3 Avanti
D Ajatashatru	4 Kosala

A. 1 2 3 4 B. 4 3 2 1 C. 3 2 4 1 D. 4 1 3 2

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Big Four kings. **Ans: C.** Pradyota–Avanti; Udayana–Vatsa; Prasenjit–Kosala; Ajatashatru–Magadha.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which inscription is the evidence of King Nanda?

A. Hathigumpha inscription of Kharavela
B. Rummindei pillar inscription
C. Junagarh inscription of Rudradaman
D. Ayodhya inscription of Dhandeva

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Nanda canal / Jina image memory sits in Kharavela's text. **Ans: A.** **Hathigumpha** of Kharavela.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Read the statements (A) and (B):

(A) The sixth century BCE was a period of great religious upheaval in all parts of the world.
(B) The Vedic religion had become very complex.

A. Both false B. Both true C. A true, B false D. A false, B true

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** Global upheaval + Vedic ritual complexity; both accepted true. **Ans: B.** Both (A) and (B) are true.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Chanda Pradyota was the ruler of which ancient state?

A. Kashi B. Anga C. Avanti D. Vajji

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Avanti king treated by Jivaka. **Ans: C.** Avanti.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Who defeated and assimilated the Vajjis into Magadha?

A. Chandragupta Maurya B. Ashoka C. Mahapadma Nanda D. Ajatashatru

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Long Vajji war = Ajatashatru. **Ans: D.** Ajatashatru.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Arrange Magadhan dynasties: 1 Nandas 2 Sungas 3 Mauryas 4 Haryankas

A. 2-1-4-3 B. 4-1-3-2 C. 3-2-1-4 D. 1-3-4-2

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Haryanka → (Shishunaga omitted in options) → Nanda → Maurya → Shunga. Code uses 4,1,3,2. **Ans: B.** Haryanka → Nanda → Maurya → Shunga (Shishunaga absent from the option set).

Chapter 06: Foreign Invasions — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to the invaders in Ancient India, which one of the following is the correct chronological order?

A. Greeks — Sakas — Kushans
B. Greeks — Kushans — Sakas
C. Sakas — Greeks — Kushans
D. Sakas — Kushans — Greeks

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Greeks (Hellenistic) → Sakas → Kushans.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

***Milind Panho* is in the form of a dialogue between King Milind and a Buddhist saint. The concerned saint was—**

A. Nagarjun B. Nagbhatt C. Nagasena D. Kumaril Bhatt

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Nagasena.** Milinda = Menander.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Assertion (A): After campaigning for nearly two years, Alexander left India in 325 BCE.
Reason (R): He was defeated by Chandragupta Maurya.

A. Both true and R explains A
B. Both true but R does not explain A
C. A true, R false
D. A false, R true

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: A/R logic:** A tests return date (~325); R tests a false defeat story. **Ans: C.** He returned about **325 BCE**; he was **not** defeated by Chandragupta.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

The women of which Indian republic or kingdom had taken up arms against Alexander after a large number of its soldiers had been killed?

A. Abhisara B. Glausai C. Katha D. Massaga

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Massaga / Assakenoi. **Ans: D.** Massaga.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Alexander's success in India was due to:

1. No central power
2. Superior army
3. Traitorous Indian rulers
4. Good administrator

A. 1 and 2 B. 1, 2 and 3 C. 2, 3 and 4 D. All

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Drop statement 4. **Ans: B.** 1, 2 and 3.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Name the brave Indian King whom Alexander defeated on the bank of river Jhelum.

A. Ambhi B. Porus C. Chandragupta Maurya D. Mahapadma Nanda

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Hydaspes = Porus; Ambhi was ally. **Ans: B.** Porus.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Who one of the following had not come to India with Alexander?

A. Nearchus B. Onesicritus C. Deimachus D. Aristobulus

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Deimachus → Bindusara. **Ans: C.** Deimachus.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Which dynasty was ruling over North India at the time of Alexander's invasion?

A. Nanda B. Maurya C. Sunga D. Kanva

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Dhana Nanda contemporary; Mauryas come after. **Ans: A.** Nanda (Dhana / Agrammes).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

With reference to foreign invaders in north-west India, which of the following is/are correct?

1. Correct order is Greeks → Kushans → Sakas.
2. Kushans come before Sakas in the standard sequence.
3. Parthians (Pahlavas) form a brief phase between Sakas and Kushan peak.

A Only 3	**B** 1 and 2
C 2 and 3	**D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 1 false: Standard order is Greeks → Sakas → (Parthians) → Kushans. Stmt 2 remains false: Kushans do not precede Sakas.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Item)	List-II (Association)
1 Hydaspes	A Beas — mutiny / turn-back
2 Hyphasis	B Jhelum — battle vs Porus
3 Ambhi	C Taxila ally of Alexander
4 Porus	D Paurava opponent, then restored

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D	**B** 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D
C 1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-C	**D** 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Hydaspes–Jhelum battle; Hyphasis–Beas turn-back; Ambhi ally; Porus foe-then-satrap. **Logic:** Never merge battle river with mutiny river.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Arrange the following in chronological order (earliest first):

1. Seleucus–Chandragupta settlement (~305–303 BCE)
2. Alexander's Indian campaign (~327–325 BCE)
3. Battle of Ipsus (301 BCE)
4. Darius I's Hindush satrapy (~518 BCE)

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** 4, 1, 2, 3
- **B** 4, 2, 1, 3
- **C** 2, 4, 1, 3
- **D** 4, 2, 3, 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Darius → Alexander → Seleucus treaty → Ipsus. **Logic:** Persian door precedes Macedon; elephants from treaty matter at Ipsus.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Alexander's army mutinied at the Hyphasis (Beas) and turned back.

Reason (R): Hydaspes is the river of the Porus battle; Beas is the turn-back.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Both true; R correctly distinguishes the two river events that explain A. **A/R logic:** Hydaspes ≠ Hyphasis spelling trap.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

With reference to Greeks around Alexander, which of the following is/are correct?

1. Aristotle tutored Alexander but never came to India.
2. Kalanos refused Alexander; Dandamis went with him to the West.
3. Deimachus came with Alexander as his admiral.

- **A** 1 and 2
- **B** Only 1
- **C** 2 and 3
- **D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 2 false: Roles reverse — Kalanos went with Alexander; Dandamis refused. Stmt 3 remains false: Deimachus is later Seleucid envoy; admiral = Nearchus.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

A Megasthenes — Seleucid envoy after Chandragupta treaty

B Nearchus — Alexander's admiral

C Sandrokottos — Chandragupta Maurya

D Agrammes — Menander of Sagala

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Agrammes / Xandrames is Dhana Nanda, not Menander. **Logic:** Greek name pegs: Sandrokottos = Chandragupta; Agrammes = last Nanda.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to Indo-Greek power, which of the following is/are correct?

1. Demetrius entered India before Diodotus freed Bactria.
2. Menander (Milinda) ruled from Sagala (Sialkot) and dialogued with Nagasena.
3. Sagala and Sangala are the same Kathaioi town stormed by Alexander.

A 1 and 2

B 2 and 3

C Only 2

D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 1 false: Diodotus freed Bactria first; Demetrius entered India later. Stmt 3 remains false: Sagala (Menander) ≠ Sangala (Alexander).

Chapter 07: Mauryan Empire — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Consider the following statements with respect to Ashoka:

1. The definition of Dhamma given by Ashoka is taken from "Rahulovada-sutta".
2. In the 14th year of his coronation, Ashoka appointed a new type of staff, called Dhamma-mahamatras.

A. Both 1 and 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Only 1 D. Only 2

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2.** Dhamma-mahamatras in the 14th year. *Rahulovada* definition is false.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

With reference to the Puranas, which one of the following statements is correct?

1. Information about the Mauryan dynasty is found in the Vishnu Purana.
2. Vayu Purana throws light on the Gupta system of governance.

A. Only 1 B. Only 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following Rock Edicts of Ashoka speaks of religious synthesis?

A. Rock Edict XI B. Rock Edict XII C. Rock Edict XIII D. Rock Edict II

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: XII.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

The official 'Agronomai' during Mauryan age was related with which of the following field?

A Weight and measurement	**B** Administrative management
C Construction of roads	**D** Revenue management

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Revenue management.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Which ancient city was named 'Palibothra' in the Greek texts?

A Purushpur
B Patan
C Ahichhatrapur
D Pataliputra

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Greek spelling of the Mauryan capital; Purushapura is the Peshawar distractor. **Ans: D (Series B provisional key).** Greek writers call Pataliputra **Palibothra**. Purushapura is Peshawar.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Consider the following statements with reference to the inscriptions of Ashoka:

1. Most of the inscriptions are in the Prakrit language and Brahmi script.
2. The inscriptions found at Mansehra and Shahbazgarhi are in the Prakrit language and Kharoshthi script.

A Only 1
B Only 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Default Ashokan package is Prakrit + Brahmi; NW exceptions use Kharoshthi. **Ans: C (Series B provisional key).** Statement 1 is the general rule. Statement 2 is the north-western exception pair.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Kautilya was the prime minister of —

A Chandragupta II Vikramaditya
B Ashoka
C Chandragupta Maurya
D Bindusara

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Tests Maurya vs Gupta Chandragupta identity for Chanakya's king. **Ans: C.** Kautilya (Chanakya) was the prime minister of **Chandragupta Maurya**. **Trap:** Choosing Gupta **Chandragupta II Vikramaditya** because both names share "Chandragupta."

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

The childhood / alternate name of Chanakya was —

A Vishakhadatta
B Kamandaka
C Vishnugupta
D Shamasastry

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Alternate name of Chanakya / Kautilya, not author of *Mudrarakshasa* or the modern editor. **Ans: C.** Chanakya is also called **Vishnugupta**. **Trap:** Picking **Vishakhadatta** (*Mudrarakshasa*) or **Shamasastry** (modern discoverer of the *Arthashastra*).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Arthashastra is a book on —

A Principles of Grammar
B Principles of Medicine
C Principles of Religion
D Principles of Government

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Nature of Kautilya's treatise — polity and statecraft, not a dharmashastra or medical manual. **Ans: D.** The *Arthashastra* deals with **Principles of Government**. **Trap:** Reading "artha" as only wealth/trade and missing the statecraft frame.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

According to the Saptanga theory, the seventh limb of the state is —

A Durga
B Kosha
C Mitra
D Danda

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Order of seven *prakritis*: Swami, Amatya, Janapada, Durga, Kosha, Danda, **Mitra**. **Ans: C.** The seventh Saptanga limb is **Mitra** (ally). **Trap:** Stopping at **Danda** (army) as if it were the last limb.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Deimachus came to the Mauryan court in the reign of —

A Chandragupta Maurya
B Bindusara
C Ashoka
D Dasharatha

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Successor ambassadors after Megasthenes — Deimachus under Bindusara; Dionysius under Ashoka's age contacts. **Ans: B.** Deimachus came in the reign of **Bindusara**. **Trap:** Assigning every Greek envoy to **Chandragupta** because of Megasthenes.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Archaeological remains at Kumrahar and Bulandibagh are associated with —

A Taxila
B Ujjain
C Pataliputra
D Tosali

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Excavation sites of the Mauryan capital's wooden palisade and pillared hall. **Ans: C.** Kumrahar and Bulandibagh belong to **Pataliputra**. **Trap:** Linking any Mauryan dig automatically to **Taxila**.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which of the following inscriptions proves Chandragupta Maurya's sway over western India?

A Rummindei pillar of Ashoka

B Hathigumpha inscription of Kharavela

C Junagadh inscription of Rudradaman

D Allahabad pillar of Samudragupta

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Later Junagadh text recalls Pushyagupta constructing Sudarshana under Chandragupta Maurya. **Ans: C.** The **Junagadh inscription of Rudradaman** records that western sway. **Trap:** Using Ashoka's Rummindei or Gupta Allahabad as the western Maurya proof.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Chandragupta Maurya defeated Seleucus Nicator in about —

A 326 B.C.

B 321 B.C.

C 305 B.C.

D 273 B.C.

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Date of the Seleucid war and treaty after Chandragupta's consolidation. **Ans: C.** The defeat / settlement is dated to about **305 B.C.** **Trap:** Confusing it with Alexander's Indian campaign (**326 B.C.**) or Maurya founding (**c. 321 B.C.**).

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

South Indian kingdoms are mentioned in which Ashokan record?

A First Major Rock Edict

B Second Major Rock Edict

C Twelfth Major Rock Edict

D Thirteenth Major Rock Edict

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Logic:** Chola, Pandya, Satiyaputra, Keralaputra appear in RE II (and also in RE XIII's neighbour list — stem asks the classic RE II hit). **Ans: B.** South Indian kingdoms are named in the **Second Major Rock Edict**. **Trap:** Jumping only to **RE XIII** because it also lists neighbouring peoples after Kalinga.

Chapter 08: Post-Mauryan India — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Match List-I with List-II and choose the correct answer using the code given below.

List-I (Ruler)	List-II (Dynasty)
A Mahendravarman I	1 Rashtrakuta
B Kadungon	2 Pallava
C Amoghavarsha I	3 Chola
D Rajaraja I	4 Pandya

A 4 2 3 1

B 2 4 1 3

C 2 4 3 1

D 4 2 1 3

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: 2 4 1 3.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Milind Panho is in the form of a dialogue between King Milind and a Buddhist saint. The concerned saint was—

A. Nagarjun B. Nagbhatt C. Nagasena D. Kumaril Bhatt

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Nagasena.** Milinda = Menander.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following inscriptions gives the information about two Ashwamedha Yajnas performed by the King Pushyamitra Shung?

A Saranath inscription

B Besnagar inscription

C Ayodhya inscription

D Hathigumpha inscription

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Ayodhya.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

With reference to the end of the Mauryan empire, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Pushyamitra's two ashwamedhas are recorded in the Besnagar Garuda pillar.
2. Pushyamitra Shunga killed the last Mauryan Brihadratha in 78 CE.
3. The Kanva house followed the Shungas about 73–28 BCE.

A Only 3
B 1 and 2
C 2 and 3
D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 2 false: Pushyamitra's coup is pegged to 185 BCE, not 78 CE (Shaka-era trap). Stmt 1 remains false: ashwamedhas = Ayodhya/Dhanadeva, not Besnagar.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Arrange the following northwest powers in the correct chronological order of their rise in India:

1. Kushans
2. Indo-Greeks
3. Shakas

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1–2–3
B 3–2–1
C 2–1–3
D 2–3–1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Greeks → Sakas → Kushans. **Logic:** Short match-list order; Parthians sit between Shakas and Kushans in fuller teaching.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Inscription / record)	List-II (Associated person)
1 Hathigumpha	A Heliodorus
2 Ayodhya inscription	B Kharavela
3 Besnagar Garuda pillar	C Pushyamitra (via Dhanadeva)
4 Nasik prasasti of Balashri	D Gautamiputra Satakarni

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1-C, 2-B, 3-A, 4-D

B 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D

C 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

D 1-D, 2-C, 3-A, 4-B

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D. **Logic:** Classic inscription traps: Hathigumpha≠Ashoka; Ayodhya≠Besnagar; Nasik = Gautamiputra vs Nahapana.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Rudradaman's Junagadh / Girnar inscription is the first long literary Sanskrit prose record in India.

Reason (R): The same rock tells that Sudarshana lake was first dug under Chandragupta Maurya, adorned under Ashoka, and repaired by Rudradaman.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) explains (A). **A/R logic:** R is the content that makes Junagadh the classic Shaka Sanskrit prose fact.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

With reference to the Satavahanas, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Tradition names Simuka as founder; capitals include Pratishthana and Pataliputra.
2. Satavahanas issued large imperial gold as their main coinage.
3. Gautamiputra Satakarni defeated Shaka Nahapana of the Kshaharata house.

A 1 and 2
B Only 3
C 2 and 3
D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 1 false: Capitals include Pratishthana and Amaravati — not Pataliputra. Stmt 2 remains false: Satavahanas did not issue large imperial gold as main coinage.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Menander — Sagala (Sialkot); Milinda Panha with Nagasena
B Maues / Moga — first Shaka named in India at Taxila–Gandhara
C Karikala — imperial Chola of Thanjavur who built Brihadisvara
D Kanishka — Fourth Buddhist Council at Kundalvana; Devaputra

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Karikala is the Sangam Chola of Kallanai; Rajaraja I is the imperial Thanjavur Chola. **Logic:** Sangam Chola vs imperial Chola swap.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

With reference to Kushan chronology and culture, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Patanjali of the Mahabhashya belongs to Kanishka's court.
2. Keys peg Kanishka's accession to 57 BCE, the start of the Vikrama Samvat.
3. Vikrama Samvat begins in 57 BCE and differs from the Shaka era by 135 years.

A 1 and 2
B 2 and 3
C Only 3
D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 2 false: Kanishka's accession is pegged to 78 CE (Shaka era); Vikrama Samvat is 57 BCE. Stmt 1 remains false: Patanjali is Shunga-age, not Kanishka's court.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Sangam house)	List-II (Emblem / capital)
1 Chera	A Fish; Madurai
2 Chola	B Bow; Vanji / Karur
3 Pandya	C Tiger; Uraiyur

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1-A, 2-C, 3-B

B 1-C, 2-B, 3-A

C 1-B, 2-C, 3-A

D 1-B, 2-A, 3-C

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: 1-B, 2-C, 3-A. **Logic:** Muvendar tag: Chera–bow–Vanji; Chola–tiger–Uraiyur; Pandya–fish–Madurai.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Consider the following statements about Indo-Greeks and Shakas:

1. Indo-Greeks issued the first portrait die-struck coins in India.
2. Nahapana is the greatest Kshaharata; Rudradaman I is the greatest Kardamaka.
3. Gondophares is the brief Parthian / Pahlava bridge king.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Only 1, 2 and 3

B Only 1 and 2

C Only 2 and 3

D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: All three statements are correct. **Logic:** All three are Must-Score northwest facts.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Gandhara art is the default Satavahana Andhra limestone narrative school.

Reason (R): Amaravati art is Satavahana Andhra limestone narrative relief, while Gandhara is Kushan northwest Greco-Buddhist schist art.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B. (A) is false, but (R) is true

C. (A) is true, but (R) is false

D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: (A) is false, but (R) is true. **A/R logic:** A swaps the schools; R states the correct pair.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

With reference to Sangam ports and trade, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Muziris is the Chola port; Puhar is Chera; Korkai is Pandya pearl coast.
2. Pallava and Kadamba are named among the great Sangam ruling houses in that corpus.
3. Arikamedu (Periplus Poduke) yields Roman amphorae.

A. 1 and 2

B. 2 and 3

C. 1 and 3

D. Only 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 1 false: Muziris = Chera/Roman pepper; Puhar = Chola; Korkai = Pandya. Stmt 2 remains false: Pallava/Kadamba are not Sangam great houses.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to Kushan capitals and art, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Purushapura (Peshawar) is the main Kushan capital; Mathura is the second great Indian centre.
2. Mathura art uses red sandstone; Gandhara often uses green schist.
3. Vima Kadphises mainly issued copper while Kujula flooded India with imperial gold.

A. Only 1 and 3

B. Only 1

C. Only 1 and 2

D. Only 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: 1 and 2 only are correct. **Logic:** Stmt 3 reversed: Kujula mainly copper; Vima issues large-scale gold.

Chapter 09: Gupta Age — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which of the following works was NOT written by Kalidasa?

1. Meghaduta
2. Raghuvamsha
3. Shringara Shataka

A. 1 and 2 B. Only 3 C. 2 and 3 D. Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Only 3.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Match List-I (Writer) with List-II (Book):

List-I (Writer)	List-II (Book)
A Trivikram Bhatta	1 Gita Govinda
B Somdev	2 Brihatkathamanjari
C Jaidev	3 Nal Champu
D Kshemendra	4 Kathasaritsagara

A 3 4 1 2
B 4 3 2 1
C 4 3 1 2
D 3 4 2 1

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: 3 4 1 2.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Consider the following foreign travellers and arrange them in ascending chronological order:

1. I-Tsing 2. Al-Biruni 3. Huentsang (Hiuen Tsang) 4. Fahyan (Fa-Hien)

A. 1, 2, 3, 4 B. 4, 3, 1, 2 C. 2, 1, 4, 3 D. 3, 4, 2, 1

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: 4, 3, 1, 2.** Fa-Hien is the Gupta-age peg.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

With reference to the Puranas, which one of the following statements is correct?

1. Information about the Mauryan dynasty is found in the Vishnu Purana.
2. Vayu Purana throws light on the Gupta system of governance.

A. Only 1 B. Only 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1.** Vishnu Purana has Mauryas. Vayu is not a Gupta admin manual.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

With reference to Chandragupta-II, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The strongest evidence in the context of Shaka Victory is the silver coins of this king.
2. The weight of these coins used to be about 33 grains.

A. Neither 1 nor 2 B. Both 1 and 2 C. Only 2 D. Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Both 1 and 2.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists (Samudragupta's contemporary kings of South India):

List-I (King)	List-II (Kingdom)
A Dhananjaya	1 Avamukta
B Nilaraja	2 Kanchi
C Ugrasena	3 Kusthalapura
D Vishnugopa	4 Palakka

A 1 2 3 4
B 2 3 4 1
C 3 1 4 2
D 4 3 2 1

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: 3 1 4 2.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

With reference to the imperial Gupta line, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Sri Gupta and Ghatotkacha carry only the title Maharaja.
2. Chandragupta I is the first Gupta Maharajadhiraja.
3. The imperial capital is traditionally Pataliputra; span is roughly 320–550 CE.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Only 1 and 2
B All 1, 2 and 3
C 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: All three statements are correct. **Logic:** All three are Must-Score Gupta foundation facts.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (King)	List-II (Tag)
1 Samudragupta	A Sakari; ends Western Kshatrapas
2 Chandragupta II	B Digvijaya; Prayag Prashasti
3 Kumaragupta I	C Nalanda founder-patron
4 Skandagupta	D Bhitari Huna war; last great imperial

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D

B 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

C 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D

D 1-D, 2-A, 3-C, 4-B

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D. **Logic:** Do not swap Samudra digvijaya with CG II Shaka war.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Chandragupta II's strongest Shaka-victory proof is his silver rupaka coins of about 33 grains.

Reason (R): Gold dinaras are prestige types and are not that Shaka-victory proof.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A). **A/R logic:** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) does NOT explain (A). Specific example, evidence artifact, or negative distractor is not a causal explanation.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Arrange the following travellers in chronological order of their visit to India:

1. Al-Biruni
2. Fa-Hien
3. Hiuen Tsang
4. I-Tsing

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 2–3–4–1	**B** 2–4–3–1
C 3–2–4–1	**D** 2–3–1–4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Fa-Hien → Hiuen Tsang → I-Tsing → Al-Biruni. **Logic:** Fa-Hien under CG II; Xuanzang under Harsha.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A King-queen gold type — Chandragupta I	**B** Lyrist / horse / battle-axe — Samudragupta
C Archer type — Kumaragupta I	**D** Silver rupaka ~33 grains — Chandragupta II

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Archer type belongs to Chandragupta II; peacock types often mark Kumaragupta I. **Logic:** Coin-type confused pair.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to Samudragupta's digvijaya, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. In the north he uprooted nine kings and annexed land; in the south he defeated then restored twelve kings as tribute.
2. Vishnugopa of Kanchi is among the south matches in the Prashasti.
3. V. A. Smith called him the Napoleon of India.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1, 2 and 3	**B** 2 and 3
C Only 1	**D** Only 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: All three statements are correct. **Logic:** All three are Must-Score Samudragupta facts.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Consider the following statements about Gupta administration:

1. Provinces are vishaya under kumaramatya; districts are bhukti under uparika.
2. Gupta rule was a Mauryan-style spy-state more central than the Mauryas.
3. The ladder is Bhukti → Vishaya → Vithi → Grama.

A Only 3	**B** 1 and 2
C 2 and 3	**D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 1 false: Roles reverse — bhukti/uparika = province; vishaya/kumaramatya = district. Stmt 2 remains false: Guptas are not a tighter Mauryan-style spy-state.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Fa-Hien visited India about 399–414 CE under Chandragupta II.

Reason (R): Fa-Hien is the Chinese witness of Harsha's Kannauj assembly of 643 CE.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)	**B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false	**D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: (A) is true, but (R) is false. **A/R logic:** Xuanzang is Harsha's witness, not Fa-Hien.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Author / work)	List-II (Fact)
1 Kalidasa	A Shringara Shataka
2 Bhartrihari	B Chandragupta II court tradition
3 Somadeva	C Kathasaritsagara
4 Jayadeva	D Gita Govinda

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

B 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D

C 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D

D 1-D, 2-A, 3-C, 4-B

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D. **Logic:** Do not give Shringara Shataka to Kalidasa.

Chapter 10: Post-Gupta Period — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which one of the following pairs is **NOT** correctly matched?

A. Ishanavarman — Harha stone inscription
B. Sarvavarman — Gaya Copper Plate
C. Jivitagupta II — Deva Barnark inscription
D. Ishwaravarman — Jaunpur stone inscription

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Gaya copper plate ≠ Maukhari Sarvavarman.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

(trap only)

Hathigumpha inscription is the source of information about which of the following rulers?

A. Kharvela B. Ashok C. Harshavardhan D. Kanishka

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Kharavela.** Option C is the Harsha distractor. Home of the inscription = Post-Mauryan file.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

With reference to the post-Gupta Huna check, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Hunas are led first by Toramana, then by Mihirakula of Sakala (Sialkot).
2. Yashodharman of Malwa boasts the Huna check at Mandasor about 532 CE.
3. Vasula is remembered as composer of Yashodharman's Sondani / Sondhni record.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2
B. All 1, 2 and 3
C. 2 and 3
D. Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: All three statements are correct. **Logic:** All three are Must-Score Huna/Yashodharman facts.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (House)	List-II (Seat)
1 Pushyabhuti	A Valabhi
2 Maukhari	B Thanesar → later Kannauj
3 Maitraka	C Kannauj
4 Gauda (Shashanka)	D Karnasuvarna

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1-C, 2-B, 3-A, 4-D

B 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D

C 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

D 1-D, 2-C, 3-A, 4-B

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D. **Logic:** Do not swap Pushyabhuti early capital with Maukhari Kannauj.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Harsha of the Pushyabhuti house ruled 606–647 CE and is a post-Gupta reunion king.

Reason (R): Harsha is the last imperial Gupta emperor of Pataliputra.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: (A) is true, but (R) is false. **A/R logic:** Harsha is not a Gupta emperor.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Arrange the following Chinese travellers in chronological order:

1. I-Tsing
2. Fa-Hien
3. Sung-yun
4. Hiuen Tsang

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 2–4–3–1	**B** 2–3–4–1
C 3–2–4–1	**D** 2–3–1–4

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: Fa-Hien → Sung-yun → Hiuen Tsang → I-Tsing. **Logic:** Must-Score traveller chronology.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Ishanavarman — Haraha (Barabanki, UP, 554 CE)	**B** Ishvaravarman — Jaunpur stone
C Sarvavarman — Gaya copper plate	**D** Jivitagupta II — Deo-Baranark

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Gaya copper plate is Samudragupta; Sarvavarman's fact is the Asirgarh seal. **Logic:** Classic Maukhari NOT-matched trap.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

With reference to Harsha's capitals and family, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Sister Rajyashri married Maitraka Dhruvasena of Valabhi.
2. Early capital is Thanesar (Sthaneshvara) in Haryana; later capital is Kannauj in Uttar Pradesh.
3. Elder brother Rajyavardhana was killed by Maitraka Dhruvasena of Valabhi.

A Only 2	**B** 1 and 2
C 2 and 3	**D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 2 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 3 false: Rajyavardhana was killed by Shashanka of Gauda. Stmt 1 remains false: Rajyashri married Maukhari Grihavarman, not Dhruvasena.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Consider the following statements about Harsha and Pulakeshin II:

1. About 630–634 CE Pulakeshin II stopped Harsha at the Narmada.
2. The boast sits in the Allahabad Pillar inscription of Harisena.
3. This Narmada stop is the same as the Battle of Kannauj 1540.

- **A** 1 and 2
- **B** Only 1
- **C** 2 and 3
- **D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 2 false: Pulakeshin II's Narmada stop boast sits in Aihole (Ravikirti/Meguti); Allahabad Pillar is Samudragupta/Harisena. Stmt 3 remains false: Kannauj 1540 is Sher Shah/Humayun.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Harshacharita is Banabhatta's prose biography (akhyayika) of Harsha.

Reason (R): Kadambari is Banabhatta's unfinished prose romance (katha).

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A). **A/R logic:** Both true as distinct Bana works; R does not explain why Harshacharita is a biography.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Record)	List-II (Owner / use)
1 Banskhera	A Harsha copper-plate with signature
2 Madhuban	B Harsha grant
3 Sonpat seal	C Pushyabhuti family
4 Hathigumpha	D Kharavela (not Harsha)

Row order is not the answer code.

A 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D

B 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

C 1-A, 2-C, 3-B, 4-D

D 1-D, 2-B, 3-C, 4-A

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D. **Logic:** Hathigumpha is the classic Harsha distractor.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to Hiuen Tsang, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. He was in India about 399–414 CE, studied at Nalanda under Shilabhadra, and wrote the Si-Yu-Ki.
2. He is Chandragupta II's Chinese witness, not Harsha's.
3. He notes Mathura for cotton textiles and Varanasi for silk.

A 1 and 2

B 2 and 3

C Only 3

D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. **Logic:** Stmt 1 false: 399–414 is Fa-Hien's window; Xuanzang is ~630–644 with Si-Yu-Ki under Harsha/Shilabhadra. Stmt 2 remains false: Xuanzang is Harsha's witness, not CG II's.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Consider the following statements about Harsha's assemblies and titles:

1. Chinese title for Harsha is Siladitya; Harsha-samvat starts in 606 CE.
2. Kannauj assembly in 643 honoured Xuanzang; Prayag Moksha-parishad was held every five years.
3. East ally is Bhaskaravarman of Kamarupa.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** 1, 2 and 3
- **B** 1 and 2
- **C** Only 2 and 3
- **D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: All three statements are correct. **Logic:** All three are Must-Score Harsha tags.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Banabhatta — Harsha's court poet; ornate Sanskrit prose
- **B** Kalidasa — Gupta poetry/drama tradition
- **C** Harshacharita — Chinese Si-Yu-Ki of Xuanzang
- **D** Nagananda — one of three plays often given to Harsha

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Harshacharita is Bana's Sanskrit biography; Si-Yu-Ki is Xuanzang's Chinese record. **Logic:** Harshacharita vs Si-Yu-Ki confused pair.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Arrange the following events related to Harsha's age in chronological order:

1. Harsha's death and north fragmentation
2. Start of Harsha-samvat / accession
3. Pulakeshin II's Narmada check
4. Kannauj assembly for Xuanzang

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** 2–3–4–1
- **B** 2–4–3–1
- **C** 3–2–4–1
- **D** 2–3–1–4

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: 606 accession → ~630–34 Narmada → 643 Kannauj → 647 death. **Logic:** Keep assembly after the Chalukya check.

Chapter 11: Ancient Indian Administration — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Consider the following statements with respect to Ashoka:

1. The definition of Dhamma given by Ashoka is taken from "Rahulovada-sutta".
2. In the 14th year of his coronation, Ashoka appointed a new type of staff, called Dhamma-mahamatras.

A Both 1 and 2	B Neither 1 nor 2
C Only 1	D Only 2

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Only 2.** Dhamma-mahamatras year 14 (Rock Edict V). *Rahulovada-sutta* is a trap; Ashoka's Dhamma definition in Pillar Edicts II & VII emphasizes *apasinave bahukayane daya dane sace socaye* (freedom from depravity, many good deeds, compassion, charity, truthfulness, purity), not derived verbatim from Rahulovada-sutta.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Which officer was known as **'Bhagadugha' during Vedic administration?**

A Messenger	B Chief Officer of Forests
C Chief Officer of the Gambling Department	D Revenue Collector

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Bhagadugha = Vedic revenue collector of the king's share (*bhaga*). Akshavapa = dice/gambling officer.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

With reference to the Puranas, which one of the following statements is correct?

1. Information about the Mauryan dynasty is found in the Vishnu Purana.
2. Vayu Purana throws light on the Gupta system of governance.

A Only 1	B Only 2
C Both 1 and 2	D Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 1.** Vishnu Purana contains genealogical accounts of the Mauryas. Vayu Purana discusses Gupta dynastic rule/territories, but does NOT throw light on their system of governance.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Which one of the following pairs is **NOT correctly matched?**

A Ishanavarman — Harha stone inscription

B Sarvavarman — Gaya Copper Plate

C Jivitagupta II — Deva Barnark inscription

D Ishwaravarman — Jaunpur stone inscription

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: NOT matched = Sarvavarman — Gaya copper plate. The Gaya copper plate belongs to Samudragupta (spurious/authentic copper plate grant). Sarvavarman's epigraphic record is the Asirgarh bronze/copper seal.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

The official 'Agronomai' during Mauryan age was related with which of the following field?

A Weight and measurement

B Administrative management

C Construction of roads

D Revenue management

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Agronomai (recorded by Megasthenes) = Mauryan rural officials in charge of district administration and land/revenue management. Weights and measures were headed by Pautavadhyaksha.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

The Hathigumpha inscription is associated with:

A Kharavela

B Ashoka

C Rudradaman

D Samudragupta

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Hathigumpha inscription at Udayagiri hills near Bhubaneswar (Odisha) records the achievements of Kalinga king Kharavela of the Mahameghavahana/Chedi dynasty.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Match List-I with List-II (Samudragupta's southern contemporaries) and select the correct code:

List-I (Ruler)	List-II (Kingdom)
A Dhananjaya	1 Kanchi
B Nilaraja	2 Avamukta
C Ugrasena	3 Kusthalapura
D Vishnugopa	4 Palaka

Codes: A B C D

A 1 2 3 4

B 2 1 4 3

C 3 2 4 1

D 4 3 1 2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: (3-2-4-1).** Dhananjaya–Kusthalapura, Nilaraja–Avamukta, Ugrasena–Palaka, Vishnugopa–Kanchi. Mentioned in the Prayag Prashasti (Allahabad Pillar) composed by Harishena.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

The Ayodhya inscription recording two ashvamedhas is associated with:

A Chandragupta Maurya

B Ashoka

C Pushyamitra Shunga

D Samudragupta

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: The Ayodhya stone inscription of Dhanadeva refers to Senapati Pushyamitra Shunga performing two Ashwamedha sacrifices. Besnagar pillar is associated with Heliodorus.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

With reference to royal titles in ancient India, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Ashoka on edicts is Devanampiya Piyadassi; his personal name never appears on any edict.
2. Chandragupta I is Vikramaditya and the first Gupta Maharajadhiraja.
3. Bindusara is Amitraghata; Kanishka is Devaputra; Harsha is Siladitya.

A Only 3

B 1 and 2

C 2 and 3

D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. Statement 1 is false because personal name Ashoka appears at Maski, Gujarra, Nittur, and Udegolam. Statement 2 is false because Chandragupta I was Maharajadhiraja, but Vikramaditya was the title of Chandragupta II.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Title)	List-II (Ruler)
1 Dakshinapathapati (दक्षिणापथपति)	A Rudradaman I
2 Mahameghavahana (महामेघवाहन)	B Gautamiputra Satakarni
3 Mahakshatrapa (महाक्षत्रप)	C Kharavela
4 Ekarat / Sarvakshatrantaka (एकराट् / सर्वक्षत्रान्तक)	D Mahapadma Nanda

A. 1-C, 2-B, 3-A, 4-D

B. 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D

C. 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

D. 1-D, 2-C, 3-A, 4-B

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: 1-B (Dakshinapathapati — Gautamiputra Satakarni), 2-C (Mahameghavahana — Kharavela), 3-A (Mahakshatrapa — Rudradaman I), 4-D (Ekarat — Mahapadma Nanda).

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Mauryan Samaharta collects revenue while Sannidhata stores the treasury.
Reason (R): Kautilya's Arthashastra established functional separation between the assessment-collection wing and the custodial treasury department.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B. (A) is false, but (R) is true

C. (A) is true, but (R) is false

D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A). Samaharta oversees revenue assessment and collection while Sannidhata is the chief custodian of the state storehouses and treasury (*koshadhyaksha*).

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Arrange the following political horizons in chronological order for administrative evolution and titles:

1. Gupta (Imperial titles & Samanta hierarchy)
2. Vedic Rajan & Ratnin councils
3. Harsha (Paramabhattaraka & feudatory assembly)
4. Mauryan centralized bureaucracy (Amatyas & Adhyakshas)

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** 2–1–4–3
- **B** 2–4–1–3
- **C** 4–2–1–3
- **D** 2–4–3–1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: 2 (Vedic) → 4 (Maurya, c. 322–185 BCE) → 1 (Gupta, c. 319–550 CE) → 3 (Harsha, 606–647 CE).

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

- **A** Hathigumpha — Kharavela
- **B** Ayodhya — Pushyamitra's two ashwamedhas
- **C** Besnagar — Pushyamitra ashwamedha record
- **D** Prayag Prashasti — Samudragupta by Harishena

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Besnagar pillar inscription records Heliodorus, the Greek envoy of Antialcidas to King Bhagabhadra, dedicating a Garuda pillar as a Bhagavata (Vaishnava). It does NOT record Pushyamitra Shunga's ashwamedhas (which are recorded on the Ayodhya stone inscription of Dhanadeva).

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

With reference to Vedic officials, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Sabha was an aristocratic council of elders, while Samiti was the general assembly of the entire tribe.
2. Bhagadugha was the collector of the king's share of agricultural produce.
3. Akshavapa was the chief of the royal chariots.

- **A** 1 and 2
- **B** 2 and 3
- **C** Only 2
- **D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is incorrect because Akshavapa was the superintendent of gambling/dice games and keeper of dice, while Suta was the royal charioteer/bard.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Consider the following statements about ancient Indian officials:

1. Megasthenes' Agronomai were district-level revenue and land administrators.
2. In Mauryan administration, weights and measures were supervised by Pautavadhyaksha.
3. Rajuka in Mauryan times discharged judicial and land measurement duties; Uparika was a provincial governor in the Gupta period.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Only 2 and 3

B Only 1

C Only 1 and 2

D All 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: All three statements are correct and represent classic UPPCS match-list facts.

Chapter 12: Ancient Indian Economy — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Consider the following statements with reference to early trade:

1. There are references of numerous river-ports in ancient India.
2. There were large entrepots of goods and traffic.

A Both 1 and 2
B Neither 1 nor 2
C Only 1
D Only 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Both 1 and 2 are correct. Ancient literary sources (Jatakas, Arthashastra, Periplus) and archaeological excavations confirm numerous riverine landing ports (*nadi-pattana*) along the Ganga, Yamuna, Narmada, and Godavari, as well as major inland entrepôts (*bhandagaras* / redistribution centers) like Pataliputra, Ujjain, Varanasi, and Kaushambi.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

With reference to Chandragupta-II, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The strongest evidence in the context of Shaka Victory is the silver coins of this king.
2. The weight of these coins used to be about 33 grains.

A Neither 1 nor 2
B Both 1 and 2
C Only 2
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Both 1 and 2 are correct. Chandragupta II Vikramaditya issued silver coins (*rupaka*) closely modeled on the Western Shaka Kshatrapa silver drachms (~33 grains) to commemorate his conquest of Gujarat and Saurashtra. Gold dinaras (~120–144 grains) are the classic exam distractor.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

From which archaeological site of the Indus Valley Civilization are figures or models of boats found?

A Dholavira and Bhagatrav
B Harappa and Kot Diji
C Mohenjo-daro and Lothal
D Kalibangan and Ropar

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Terracotta boat models and representations on seals have been excavated from **Mohenjo-daro** (seal with boat and mast) and **Lothal** (terracotta boat models with provision for oars and masts). Lothal also possesses the world's earliest artificial tidal dockyard.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Society / Era)	List-II (Economic Character)
A Indus Valley Civilization	1 Pastoral
B Later Vedic Society	2 Land Lordism / Feudalism
C Rigvedic Society	3 Agrarian
D Medieval Period	4 Urban

Codes: A B C D

A 4 2 3 1

B 2 1 4 3

C 3 4 1 2

D 4 3 1 2

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: (4-3-1-2).** Indus Valley = Urban (bronze age city crafts & trade); Later Vedic = Agrarian (settled agriculture, iron ploughshares, PGW); Rigvedic = Pastoral (cattle-rearing, voluntary *bali*); Medieval = Landlordism (feudal agrarian estates, jagirs).

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Which of the following institutions belonged to foreign trade?

A Śreni

B Nagaram

C Nānādesis

D Manigrama

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Manigrama (मणिग्रामम) was an influential guild of South Indian merchants specifically engaged in maritime and trans-oceanic foreign trade, active from the Pallava-Chola era across Southeast Asia (confirmed by the 9th-century Takua Pa inscription in Thailand).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

With reference to the economy-type ladder, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Vedic nishka is a minted punch-marked silver coin.
2. Indus = Pastoral; Rigvedic = Urban; Later Vedic = Agrarian; medieval slot = landlordism.
3. The Indus uses weights and seals but has no coins.

A 1 and 2

B Only 3

C 2 and 3

D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Only 3 is correct. Statement 1 is false: Vedic *nishka* was a gold bullion unit or neck ornament, not a minted coin. Statement 2 is false: Indus was Urban, Rigvedic was Pastoral, and Later Vedic was Agrarian.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Coin Stage)	List-II (Key Numismatic Feature)
1 Punch-marked silver	A First portrait die-struck coins
2 Indo-Greek	B First coins (~6th c. BCE); *karshapana / pana*
3 Kushan (Vima Kadphises)	C Gold coinage becomes regular and common
4 Gupta dinara	D High-prestige gold (~120–144 grains)

A 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D

B 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

C 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D

D 1-D, 2-A, 3-C, 4-B

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D. Punch-marked silver are earliest (~6th c. BCE); Indo-Greeks introduced die-struck portraits; Kushanas under Vima Kadphises issued the first regular high-purity gold standard; Guptas issued imperial prestige dinaras.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

****Assertion (A):** Chandragupta II's Shaka-victory proof is silver rupaka coins of about 33 grains.**
****Reason (R):** The Western Kshatrapas had a well-established silver coinage circulating in Malwa and Gujarat, which Chandragupta II continued after vanquishing them.**

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A). Because the local population in the conquered Western Kshatrapa territories was accustomed to silver drachms, Chandragupta II minted the first Gupta silver coins conforming to the Kshatrapa weight standard (~33 grains).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Arrange the following coin stages in chronological order:

1. Gupta dinara
2. Punch-marked silver
3. Indo-Greek portraits
4. Kushan regular gold

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** 2–4–3–1
- **B** 2–3–4–1
- **C** 3–2–4–1
- **D** 2–3–1–4

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: 2 (Punch-marked, c. 6th c. BCE) → 3 (Indo-Greek, c. 2nd c. BCE) → 4 (Kushan gold, c. 1st c. CE) → 1 (Gupta dinara, c. 4th c. CE).

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

- **A** Shreni — general craft or trade guild headed by a shreshthin
- **B** Manigrama — foreign / overseas trade institution
- **C** Nanadesi — merchant guild operating across varied regions
- **D** Sarthavaha — permanently settled urban banker guild

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Sarthavaha was the leader/caravan conductor of mobile caravan merchants (*sartha*), NOT a permanently settled urban banker. Settled bankers/guild heads were called *Shreshthin* or *Nagara-sreshthi*.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

With reference to ports in the *Periplus of the Erythraean Sea*, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Barygaza is Broach at the Narmada mouth; Barbarikon is the Indus-mouth port.
2. Tamralipti at the Ganga mouth faces the Bay of Bengal.
3. Muziris (Muchiri) on the Malabar is the primary Roman pepper port.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** All 1, 2 and 3
- **B** Only 2 and 3
- **C** Only 1
- **D** Only 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: All three statements are correct and form key geographic markers in ancient Indian maritime trade.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Consider the following statements about inland trade routes:

1. Uttarapatha ran from Taxila through Mathura and Kaushambi towards Pataliputra and Tamralipti.
2. Dakshinapatha was an overland commercial highway connecting the Ganga plains through Ujjain with Pratishthana and the Deccan.
3. Dakshinapatha was purely a maritime coastal shipping route along the Coromandel coast.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** 1 and 2
- **B** 2 and 3
- **C** Only 1
- **D** All 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false because Dakshinapatha was primarily an overland arterial highway system traversing central India into the Deccan.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

****Assertion (A):** The earliest royal portrait coins in India were introduced by the Indo-Greeks.**
****Reason (R):** Punch-marked coins of the Mahajanapadas and Mauryas carried geometric and floral symbols without kings' names or portraits.**

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the causal explanation of (A); the introduction of portraits was an adoption of Hellenistic minting techniques by Bactrian Greek rulers.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Port / Trading Center)	List-II (Key Historical / Trade Landmark)
1 Lothal	A *Periplus* Poduke; Roman amphorae and Arretine ware
2 Arikamedu	B Earliest tidal dockyard and bead factories
3 Puhar / Kaveripattinam	C Sangam Chola premier port at the mouth of the Kaveri
4 Uraiyur	D Sangam Chola inland capital celebrated for cotton textiles

A 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D

B 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D

C 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D

D 1-D, 2-A, 3-C, 4-B

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to Indo-Roman maritime commerce, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Roman trade reached its zenith between the 1st century BCE and the 2nd century CE.
2. Pliny the Elder in his *Natural History* lamented the huge drain of Roman gold bullion (*denarii* and *aurei*) to India in exchange for luxury goods.
3. Tamralipti on the east coast was the main port for the Roman pepper trade.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Only 2

B 1 and 2

C 2 and 3

D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false because the Roman pepper trade was overwhelmingly concentrated along the Malabar and Konkan coasts of western India (Muziris, Nelcynda, and Barygaza), whereas Tamralipti faced east toward Southeast Asia and Sri Lanka.

Chapter 13: Archaeology — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which of the following archaeological sites related to the Indus Valley Civilization are situated in present-day Uttar Pradesh? (UPPCS Prelims 2025)

1. Mandi
2. Rakhigarhi
3. Hulas

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1 and 2

B Only 3

C 1 and 3

D Only 1

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: 1 and 3 are in Uttar Pradesh (Mandi is in Muzaffarnagar/Bijnor district; Hulas is in Saharanpur district). Rakhigarhi is the largest Harappan site in India, located in Hisar district of Haryana.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Match List-I (Prehistoric Site) with List-II (State) and select the correct code: (UPPCS Prelims 2023)

List-I (Site)	List-II (State)
A Nevasa	1 Rajasthan
B Isampur	2 Tamil Nadu
C Didwana	3 Maharashtra
D Gudiyam Cave	4 Karnataka

Codes: A B C D

A 3 4 1 2

B 4 3 1 2

C 3 4 2 1

D 3 2 4 1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: (3-4-1-2).** Nevasa is on the Pravara river in Maharashtra (Middle Paleolithic/Nevasan culture); Isampur is an Acheulian quarry in Karnataka; Didwana is a Lower Paleolithic site in Rajasthan (Thar margin); Gudiyam Cave is an Acheulian rock-shelter in Tamil Nadu (near Attirampakkam).

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

The eastern boundary of the Harappan culture is indicated by which of the following? (UPPCS Prelims 2023)

A Harappa
B Alamgirpur
C Rakhigarhi
D Manda

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Alamgirpur (located on the Hindon River in Meerut district, Uttar Pradesh) marks the easternmost geographical limit of the Indus Valley Civilization. Manda (J&K) is the northernmost, Daimabad (Maharashtra) the southernmost, and Sutkagen-dor (Makran, Pakistan) the westernmost.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following Indian Archaeologists first visited 'Bhimbetka Caves' and discovered the prehistoric significance of its rock paintings? (UPPCS Prelims 2020)

A Madho Swaroop Vatsa
B H.D. Sankalia
C V.S. Wakankar
D V.N. Mishra

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Dr. Vishnu Shridhar Wakankar (Vikram University, Ujjain) discovered the Bhimbetka rock-shelters in Raisen district, Madhya Pradesh, in 1957–58. H.D. Sankalia was renowned for excavations at Nevasa and Inamgaon; M.S. Vatsa excavated Harappa.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Match List-I (Harappan Site) with List-II (State / UT of India) and select the correct code: (UPPCS Prelims 2020)

List-I (Site)	List-II (State / UT)
A Balu	1 Uttar Pradesh
B Manda	2 Jammu & Kashmir
C Padri	3 Haryana
D Hulas	4 Gujarat

Codes: A B C D

A 3 2 1 4
B 2 3 4 1
C 2 4 3 1
D 3 2 4 1

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: (3-2-4-1).** Balu is in Kaithal district, Haryana; Manda is on the right bank of the Chenab in Jammu & Kashmir; Padri is in Bhavnagar district, Gujarat; Hulas is in Saharanpur district, Uttar Pradesh.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

From which archaeological site of the Indus Valley Civilization are figures or models of boats found? (UPPCS Prelims 2022)

A Dholavira and Bhagatrav
B Harappa and Kot Diji
C Mohenjo-daro and Lothal
D Kalibangan and Ropar

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: A terracotta boat model was found at Lothal, and an amulet/seal depicting a boat with a central cabin and mast was discovered at Mohenjo-daro.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

In which State of India is the Harappan Civilization site Mandi situated? (UPPCS Prelims 2021)

A Gujarat
B Haryana
C Rajasthan
D Uttar Pradesh

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Mandi is an Indus Valley site situated in Muzaffarnagar district (near Bijnor border), Uttar Pradesh, famous for the accidental discovery of a massive hoard of Harappan gold jewelry and beads.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Which of the following centres related to Indus Valley Civilization are situated in Uttar Pradesh? (UPPCS Prelims 2018)

I. Kalibangan
II. Lothal
III. Alamgirpur
IV. Hulas

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A I, II, III, IV
B I, II
C II, III
D III, IV

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: Alamgirpur (Meerut) and Hulas (Saharanpur) are in Uttar Pradesh. Kalibangan is in Hanumangarh district of Rajasthan, and Lothal is in Ahmedabad district of Gujarat.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

With reference to the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. ASI was formally founded in 1861 under Viceroy Lord Canning.
2. Alexander Cunningham served as its first Director-General and is hailed as the "Father of Indian Archaeology".
3. The statutory headquarters of the Archaeological Survey of India is situated in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

(A) Only 1
(B) 1 and 2
(C) All 1, 2 and 3
(D) Only 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: ASI headquarters is located at 24 Tilak Marg, New Delhi (Dharohar Bhawan). Lucknow houses the Directorate of UP State Archaeology and the UP State Museum, which are state-level bodies separate from ASI HQ.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Match List-I (Archaeologist) with List-II (Key Contribution / Excavation Landmark) and select the correct code:

List-I (Archaeologist)	List-II (Contribution)
A Daya Ram Sahni	1 Stratigraphic balk-and-grid method; Harappa re-excavation (1946)
B John Marshall	2 World announcement of Indus Civilization discovery (1924)
C Mortimer Wheeler	3 Discovery of earliest Paleolithic tools at Pallavaram (1863)
D Robert Bruce Foote	4 First systematic excavation of Harappa (1921)

Codes: A B C D

(A) 4 2 1 3
(B) 2 4 1 3
(C) 4 1 2 3
(D) 3 2 1 4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: (4-2-1-3).** Daya Ram Sahni excavated Harappa in 1921; John Marshall announced the civilization in 1924; Mortimer Wheeler introduced the balk-and-grid stratigraphic technique in 1944–46; Robert Bruce Foote discovered the first Indian handaxe at Pallavaram in 1863.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): In an undisturbed archaeological trench, lower stratigraphic layers are older than upper layers.
Reason (R): The archaeological law of superposition states that sedimentary and cultural deposits accumulate sequentially from bottom to top over time.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) correctly explains (A). Stratigraphy is the primary method of relative dating based on the geological/archaeological law of superposition.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to scientific dating methods in archaeology, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Carbon-14 (C-14) dating can determine the absolute age of stone handaxes and copper ingots directly.
2. The half-life of Carbon-14 is approximately 5,730 years and its effective dating range extends up to ~50,000 years before present.
3. Thermoluminescence (TL) dating is utilized to date fired pottery, bricks, and burnt flint by measuring trapped electrons released upon heating.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** 1 and 2
- **B** 2 and 3
- **C** Only 2
- **D** All 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: 2 and 3 are correct. Statement 1 is false: C-14 works exclusively on organic materials (charcoal, bone, wood, seeds, shell) that once exchanged carbon with the atmosphere; it cannot directly date inorganic stone tools or metallic objects (which must be dated via the associated organic stratum).

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Arrange the following archaeological milestones in chronological order:

1. John Marshall's announcement of the Indus Valley Civilization
2. Foundation of the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI)
3. Robert Bruce Foote's discovery of the Pallavaram handaxe
4. Sir Mortimer Wheeler's balk-and-grid excavation at Harappa

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 2–3–1–4
B 3–2–1–4
C 2–1–3–4
D 2–3–4–1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: 2 (ASI founded 1861) → 3 (Pallavaram handaxe 1863) → 1 (Marshall's IVC announcement 1924) → 4 (Wheeler's grid excavation at Harappa 1946).

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Which one of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

A S.R. Rao — Lothal tidal dockyard excavation
B B.B. Lal — Kalibangan ploughed field and fire altars
C R.S. Bisht — Dholavira stone reservoirs and signboard
D V.S. Wakankar — Sanauli royal chariot burials

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Sanauli in Baghpat district (UP) was excavated in 2018 by the ASI team led by Dr. Sanjay Kumar Manjul. Dr. V.S. Wakankar is world-famous for discovering the Bhimbetka rock shelters in Madhya Pradesh (1957–58).

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Consider the following archaeological sites situated in Uttar Pradesh:

1. Sanauli (Baghpat) — Copper-sheathed solid-wheel chariots and antenna swords (Late Harappan/OCP context)
2. Koldihwa and Mahagara (Belan Valley) — Early evidence of rice cultivation in a Neolithic-Chalcolithic horizon
3. Atranjikhera (Etah) — Crucial stratified sequence establishing Ochre Coloured Pottery (OCP) followed by Painted Grey Ware (PGW) with iron tools

Which of the statements given above are correct?

A 1 and 2 only
B 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 3 only
D All 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: All three statements are correct and represent fundamental UP archaeological landmarks tested in UPPCS examinations.

Chapter 14: Ancient India Miscellaneous — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Match List-I (Book) with List-II (Author) and select the correct answer using the codes given below: (UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q134)

List-I (Book)	List-II (Author)
A Hindu Polity	1 D.D. Kosambi
B The Wonder That Was India	2 A.L. Basham
C An Introduction to the Study of Indian History	3 K.P. Jayaswal
D The Early History of India	4 Vincent Arthur Smith

Codes: A B C D

A 3 2 4 1

B 1 2 4 3

C 3 2 1 4

D 1 2 3 4

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: (3-2-1-4).** *Hindu Polity* = K.P. Jayaswal (nationalist analysis of republics/assemblies); *The Wonder That Was India* = A.L. Basham (cultural-civilizational survey); *An Introduction to the Study of Indian History* = D.D. Kosambi (pioneering Marxist socio-economic analysis); *The Early History of India* = Vincent Arthur Smith (colonial dynastic framework).

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

***Charaka Samhita* is divided into how many chapters and sections? (UPPCS Prelims)**

A 120 chapters and 8 sections

B 100 chapters and 5 sections

C 80 chapters and 7 sections

D 60 chapters and 8 sections

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Charaka Samhita* consists of **120 chapters** (*adhyayas*) divided into **8 sections** (*sthanas*): Sutra-sthana (30), Nidana-sthana (8), Vimana-sthana (8), Sharira-sthana (8), Indriya-sthana (12), Chikitsa-sthana (30), Kalpa-sthana (12), and Siddhi-sthana (12).

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

With reference to the Puranas, which one of the following statements is correct? (UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q29)

1. Information about the Mauryan dynasty is found in the Vishnu Purana.
2. Vayu Purana throws light on the Gupta system of governance.

A Only 1
B Only 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (A)
Core Memory Fact: Only 1.** Statement 1 is correct: the Vishnu Purana contains detailed genealogical lists of the Maurya dynasty. Statement 2 is incorrect: while the Vayu Purana lists early Gupta rulers and their territories, it does NOT provide an account of the Gupta administrative or governmental system.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

The rulers of which of the following dynasty have been called as 'Shriparvatiya' in Puranas? (UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q2)

A Vakatakas
B Ikshvakus
C Shakas
D Kharavelas

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: In the Puranas, the **Ikshvakus of Vijayapuri** (Nagarjunakonda, Andhra Pradesh) are styled as *Shriparvatiya Andhrabhrityas* ("Servants of the Andhras ruling near Sriparvata / Nagarjunakonda hill").

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Match List-I (Ruling Dynasty) with List-II (Capital) and select the correct answer: (UPPCS Prelims 2019)

List-I (Dynasty)	List-II (Capital)
A Pallava	1 Warangal
B Pandya	2 Kanchi
C Yadava	3 Madura
D Kakatiya	4 Devagiri

Codes: A B C D

A 2 1 4 3
B 2 3 4 1
C 1 2 3 4
D 2 4 3 1

Correct Answer: (B)
Core Memory Fact: (2-3-4-1).** Pallava — Kanchi (Kanchipuram); Pandya — Madura (Madurai); Yadava (Seuna) — Devagiri (Daulatabad); Kakatiya — Warangal (Orugallu).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched? (UPPCS Prelims)

A Devagiri — Shankaradeva

B Warangal — Ramachandra Deva

C Hoysala — Veera Ballala III

D Madura — Veera Pandya

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Ramachandra Deva was the Yadava king of **Devagiri** (conquered by Alauddin Khalji and Malik Kafur). The ruler of **Warangal** during the Khalji invasions was Kakatiya king **Prataparudra II**.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following pairs (School of Thought — Proponent) is correctly matched? (UPPCS Prelims)

A Vaisheshika — Patanjali

B Mimansa — Kanada

C Nyaya — Gautama

D Uttara Mimansa — Kapila

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Nyaya was founded by Akshapada Gautama. Vaisheshika was founded by Kanada (Uluka); Yoga by Patanjali; Purva Mimamsa by Jaimini; Samkhya by Kapila; Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta) by Badarayana.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

With reference to the ancient materialist school of Charvaka / Lokayata, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It admits only direct perception (*pratyaksha*) as a valid means of knowledge (*pramana*).
2. It rejects the existence of a permanent soul (*atman*), karmic retribution, and rebirth.
3. Charvaka philosophy forms an integral school of the Vedic orthodox *Astika* systems.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1 and 2

B 2 and 3

C Only 1

D All 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Charvaka is an uncompromisingly heterodox (*Nastika*) school that openly repudiates the authority of the Vedas, caste hierarchy, and priestly sacrifices.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Match List-I (Old World Bronze Civilization) with List-II (Diagnostic Cultural Feature) and select the correct code:

List-I (Civilization)	List-II (Hallmark Feature)
A Mesopotamia	1 Stepped temple-towers (Ziggurats) & Cuneiform clay tablets
B Ancient Egypt	2 Monumental royal tombs (Pyramids) & Hieroglyphic papyrus
C Indus Civilization	3 Orthogonal grid cities, covered drainage & undeciphered script
D Shang China	4 Divinatory Oracle-bone script & cast bronze ritual vessels (*ding*)

Codes: A B C D

A 1 2 3 4

B 2 1 4 3

C 1 3 2 4

D 3 2 1 4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: (1-2-3-4).** Mesopotamia = Ziggurats and Cuneiform; Egypt = Pyramids and Hieroglyphs; Indus = Planned grid cities and undeciphered script; Shang China = Oracle bones and ritual bronze ding vessels.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Mesopotamian commercial and royal inscriptions regularly refer to the land of 'Meluhha'.
Reason (R): Archaeological excavations in Mesopotamia have yielded Harappan steatite seals, etched carnelian beads, and Indus weight units.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) provides the direct archaeological evidence corroborating that the Mesopotamian toponym 'Meluhha' designates the Indus Valley Civilization.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Arrange the following Kakatiya sovereigns in correct chronological sequence:

1. Queen Rudrama Devi
2. Prola II
3. Prataparudra II
4. Ganapati Deva

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 2–1–4–3
B 2–4–1–3
C 4–2–1–3
D 2–4–3–1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Prola II (established independence) → Ganapati Deva (1199–1262) → Rudrama Devi (1262–1289) → Prataparudra II (1296–1323, last ruler).

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Consider the following statements regarding Queen Rudrama Devi of the Kakatiya dynasty:

1. She assumed the male throne-name 'Rudradeva Maharaja' in her royal inscriptions and official charters.
2. The Venetian traveler Marco Polo visited the Andhra coast during her reign and recorded her able administration.
3. She was the queen-consort of a Chola monarch who took refuge in Warangal.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

A 1 and 2 only
B 2 and 3 only
C 1 and 3 only
D All 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Rudrama Devi was the daughter of Kakatiya Emperor Ganapati Deva, who formally designated her as his sovereign successor (*Puttrika*), ruling Warangal independently in her own right.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

With reference to the Ramappa (Rudreshwara) Temple, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is located at Palampet in Mulugu district of Telangana.
2. It was constructed in 1213 CE during the reign of Kakatiya ruler Ganapati Deva by his general Recharla Rudra.
3. Its shikhara was engineered using ultra-light porous bricks that can float on water.
4. It was inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2021.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** 1 and 4 only
- **B** 2 and 3 only
- **C** 1, 2 and 3 only
- **D** All 1, 2, 3 and 4

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: All four statements are correct. Ramappa Temple represents the pinnacle of Kakatiya architecture with sandbox foundation technology, floating bricks, and bracket sculptures.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Which one of the following pairs of ancient Indian texts and authors is NOT correctly matched?

- **A** *Brahmasphutasiddhanta* — Brahmagupta
- **B** *Sushruta Samhita* — Sushruta (Surgical procedures)
- **C** *Brihat Samhita* — Aryabhata
- **D** *Charaka Samhita* — Charaka (Internal medicine)

Correct Answer: (C)
Core Memory Fact: Brihat Samhita* (an encyclopedia of astronomy, astrology, geography, and weather) was composed by **Varahamihira**. Aryabhata's seminal works are the *Aryabhatiya* and *Arya-siddhanta*.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Consider the following statements about ancient Indian philosophical and scientific developments:

1. Unlike Charvaka materialism, early Buddhism accepts the doctrine of karma and rebirth while repudiating an eternal soul (*Anatta*).
2. The *Matsya Purana* contains the most exhaustive genealogical list of Andhra/Satavahana kings.
3. The traditional five characteristics (*Panchalakshana*) of a Mahapurana are Sarga, Pratisarga, Vamsha, Manvantara, and Vamshanucharita.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- **A** 1 and 2 only
- **B** 2 and 3 only
- **C** 1 and 3 only
- **D** All 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)
Core Memory Fact: All three statements are correct and represent classic high-yield prelims facts.